

**SUPREME COURT OF THE STATE OF NEW YORK
COUNTY OF BRONX**

**DEREK THOMAS, CURTIS SMALLWOOD and INDEX NO.: 807473/2024E
MIGUEL TAVERAS,**

Plaintiffs,

– against –

**AMENDED VERIFIED
COMPLAINT**

**CITY OF NEW YORK, NEW YORK CITY POLICE
DEPARTMENT, LIEUTENANT BRIAN QUERY,
POLICE OFFICER JOHN DOE and POLICE OFFICER
JOHN ROE,**

Defendant(s).

Plaintiffs, by their attorney, **NEIL WOLLERSTEIN, ESQ.**, complaining of the defendants, respectfully show to this Court and allege the following upon information and belief:

1. That at all times the Plaintiff **DEREK THOMAS** was and is a resident of County of Bronx, City and State of New York.
2. That at all times hereinafter mentioned, the defendant, CITY OF NEW YORK, hereinafter referred to as “CITY”, was and still is a municipal corporation organized and existing under and by virtue of the laws of the State of New York.
3. That at all times hereinafter mentioned the defendant, NEW YORK CITY POLICE DEPARTMENT, hereinafter referred to as “NYPD”, was and is an agency of the defendant, CITY.
4. That on and prior to 12/31/23 and at all times hereinafter mentioned the defendant, LIEUTENANT BRIAN QUERY (Shield No. 5001), hereinafter referred to as “QUERY” was and is a police officer employed by the defendant NYPD, and at all times herein was acting in such capacity as the agent, servant and employee of the CITY and NYPD.
5. That on and prior to 12/31/23 and at all times hereinafter mentioned the defendant, POLICE OFFICER JOHN DOE, hereinafter referred to as “DOE” was and is a police officer

employed by the defendant NYPD, and at all times herein was acting in such capacity as the agent, servant and employee of the CITY and NYPD.

6. That on and prior to 12/31/23 and at all times hereinafter mentioned the defendant, POLICE OFFICER JOHN ROE, hereinafter referred to as “ROE” was and is a police officer employed by the defendant NYPD, and at all times herein was acting in such capacity as the agent, servant and employee of the CITY and NYPD.

7. Upon information and belief, at all times hereinafter mentioned, and on 12/31/23, at approximately 8:00 p.m., several police officers including but not limited to QUERY, DOE and ROE were on duty and in the vicinity of Willis Avenue and East 138th Street, County of Bronx, City and State of New York.

8. Upon information and belief, at all times hereinafter mentioned, and on 12/31/23, at approximately 8:00 p.m., the above mentioned Police Officers were acting within the scope of their employment and under the direction of the CITY and NYPD as its agents, servants and/or employees.

9. Upon information and belief, defendants QUERY, DOE and ROE were all assigned to the PSA 7.

10. That on and prior to 12/31/23, QUERY, DOE and ROE were each individually hired, screened, tested, interviewed, trained, retrained, investigated, monitored and supervised by the CITY and NYPD.

11. That on and prior to 12/31/23, at approximately 8:00 p.m., and all relevant times herein after, QUERY, DOE and ROE individually and/or collectively were acting pursuant to and under the rules and regulations of the New York City Patrol Guidelines.

12. That on 12/31/23, at approximately, 8:00 p.m., Plaintiff **DEREK THOMAS** was

lawfully in the vicinity of Willis Avenue and East 138th Street, County of Bronx, City and State of New York and doing nothing illegal, improper or acting suspicious in anyway.

13. That on 12/31/23, at approximately, 8:00 p.m., in the vicinity of Willis Avenue and East 138th Street, County of Bronx, City and State of New York, QUERY, DOE and ROE, absent an arrest warrant, probable cause, reasonable cause or any legal justification, and based on fraud, perjury and misrepresentations approached Plaintiff **DEREK THOMAS** for no reason and summarily stopped, searched, grabbed, assaulted, battered, and detained him in an aggressive and excessive manner.

14. Upon information and belief QUERY, DOE and ROE knew or had reason to know that their actions lacked any legal justification in approaching, searching, seizing and arresting Plaintiff **DEREK THOMAS** and that their actions were based on fraud, perjury and misrepresentations.

15. That Plaintiff **DEREK THOMAS** was arraigned after his arrest and thereafter falsely and maliciously prosecuted with committing a crime.

16. Thereafter, Plaintiff **DEREK THOMAS** remained incarcerated for over 24 hours and was required to make numerous court appearances over an extended period of time until all charges against him were terminated favorably.

17. Plaintiff **DEREK THOMAS** sustained physical and emotional pain and injuries as a result of this incident.

18. That within ninety (90) days after the causes of actions accrued herein, and more than thirty (30) days prior to the commencement of this action, the Plaintiff **DEREK THOMAS** caused the notice of claim, in writing, sworn to by and on behalf of the claimant, the Plaintiff herein, containing the statement of the name and place of residence of the claimant by the street and number

and his attorney, and describing the time when the particular claim and circumstances under which the damages and injuries were sustained, the cause thereof, and so far as practical, the nature and extent of the injuries to be personally served upon the defendant CITY, their agents, servants and/or employees at the Law Department.

19. This action was so commenced within one (1) year and ninety (90) days after said cause of action accrued herein, and for more than thirty (30) days prior to the commencement of this action, defendant CITY neglected, refused and failed to make an adjustment of said claim, and said claim remains unadjusted and unpaid, although plaintiff herein has requested and demanded that the same be paid and adjusted.

20. That the defendants requested an oral examination pursuant to General Municipal Law Section 50-H and said request was complied with.

AS AND FOR A FIRST CAUSE OF ACTION ON BEHALF OF
PLAINTIFF DEREK THOMAS

21. Plaintiff **DEREK THOMAS** repeats, reiterates and realleges each and every allegation contained in paragraphs numbered 1 – 20 with the same force and effect as if fully set forth at length herein.

22. That on or about 12/31/23, at approximately 8:00 p.m., the Plaintiff **DEREK THOMAS** was without just cause, probable cause or provocation, and with reckless, negligent and callous disregard for the truth, and without investigation, touched, grabbed, handcuffed, seized and arrested in an excessive manner and with excessive force by CITY, NYPD, QUERY, DOE and ROE, their agents, servants and/or employees, and in particular, by QUERY, DOE and ROE.

23. That on or about 12/31/23, at approximately 8:00 p.m., the Plaintiff **DEREK THOMAS** while lawfully in the vicinity of Willis Avenue and East 138th Street, County of Bronx, City and State of New York, was without just cause, probable cause or provocation, maliciously,

intentionally and falsely accused by CITY, NYPD, QUERY, DOE and ROE of having committed a crime.

24. That on or about 12/31/23, and upon arresting the Plaintiff **DEREK THOMAS** and depriving him of his liberty, CITY, NYPD, QUERY, DOE and ROE took the Plaintiff **DEREK THOMAS** to a police station in the County of Bronx and entered him on the records as under arrest.

25. That on or about 12/31/23, the CITY, NYPD, QUERY, DOE and ROE further caused Plaintiff **DEREK THOMAS** to have his fingerprints and photographs to be taken without his consent and in accordance with police procedures for the arrest of criminals and held him on various criminal charges at various police stations, correctional facilities and at the courthouse located at 215 East 161st Street, County of Bronx, City and State of New York.

26. That on or about 12/31/23, Plaintiff **DEREK THOMAS** was aware of his arrest and confinement, he did not consent to his arrest or confinement, and said confinement, seizure, arrest and detention was without legal justification.

27. That at all times hereinafter mentioned the actions of CITY, NYPD, QUERY, DOE and ROE as described above were carried out in a reckless, deliberate, willful, wanton, malicious and grossly negligent manner.

28. That by reason of the foregoing, Plaintiff **DEREK THOMAS** has been damaged in an amount that exceeds the jurisdictional limits of all lower trial courts of this state.

**AS AND FOR A SECOND CAUSE OF ACTION ON BEHALF OF
PLAINTIFF DEREK THOMAS**

29. Plaintiff **DEREK THOMAS** repeats, reiterates and realleges each and every allegation contained in paragraphs numbered 1 – 28 with the same force and effect as if fully set forth at length herein.

30. That on or about 12/31/23, a criminal complaint was issued by the CITY, NYPD, QUERY, DOE and ROE, their agents, servants and/or employees, without probable cause, reasonable cause or legal justification.

31. That on or about 12/31/23 a criminal action against Plaintiff **DEREK THOMAS** was commenced by CITY, NYPD, QUERY, DOE and ROE, their agents, servants and/or employees, without probable cause, reasonable cause or legal justification.

32. That solely as a result of the aforesaid, the Plaintiff **DEREK THOMAS**' life was interfered with.

33. That the criminal action against Plaintiff **DEREK THOMAS** was continued for an extended period of time by defendants with malice and bad faith.

34. That solely as a result of the false arrest, assault, battery, false imprisonment and malicious prosecution of the Plaintiff **DEREK THOMAS**, he was deprived of his liberty for an extended period of time and was subjected to scorn, ridicule, embarrassment and was degraded in the esteem of the community both personally and professionally.

35. That the criminal action against Plaintiff **DEREK THOMAS** was terminated favorably.

36. That the actions of CITY, NYPD, QUERY, DOE and ROE as described above were carried out in a reckless, deliberate, willful, wanton, malicious and grossly negligent manner.

37. That by reason of the foregoing, Plaintiff **DEREK THOMAS** has been damaged in an amount that exceeds the jurisdictional limits of all lower trial courts of this state.

**AS AND FOR A THIRD CAUSE OF ACTION ON BEHALF OF
PLAINTIFF DEREK THOMAS**

38. Plaintiff **DEREK THOMAS** repeats, reiterates and realleges each and every allegation contained in paragraphs numbered 1 - 37 with the same force and effect as if fully set forth

at length herein.

39. That on or about 12/31/23, and while in the custody of the defendants in the County of Bronx, City of New York, the Plaintiff **DEREK THOMAS** was intentionally touched, pushed, assaulted, battered, violated, searched, humiliated, photographed and handcuffed in the most egregious and excessive manner by the CITY, NYPD, QUERY, DOE and ROE, who were acting within the scope of their employment and authority in such a manner as to knowingly cause injury to plaintiff.

40. That on or about 12/31/23 CITY, NYPD, QUERY, DOE and ROE, their agents, servants and employees, acting as agents and on behalf of the CITY, NYPD, QUERY, DOE and ROE, within the scope of their employment, did intentionally, willfully and maliciously assault and batter the Plaintiff **DEREK THOMAS** in the most egregious and excessive matter in that they have the real or apparent ability to cause imminent harmful and/or offensive bodily contact and intentionally did a violent and/or menacing act which threatened such contact to the Plaintiff **DEREK THOMAS** and their act caused apprehension of such contact in the plaintiff, and in a hostile and/or offensive manner touched and beat the plaintiff and/or offensive bodily contact to the Plaintiff **DEREK THOMAS** and caused such battery in and about his head, neck, back, body and limbs.

41. That by reason of the aforesaid intentional assault and battery which was committed in an excessive manner and with excessive force and without legal justification or privilege by the defendants, their agents, servants and employees, who were acting within the scope of their employment and authority and without any probable or reasonable cause, Plaintiff **DEREK THOMAS** suffered great and permanent bodily injury in and about his head, neck, back, body and limbs and was rendered sick, sore, lame and disabled, and suffered conscious pain and suffering, and

that he was otherwise damaged.

42. That as a result of the aforesaid assault and battery the Plaintiff **DEREK THOMAS** was caused to sustain serious, severe, painful and permanent bodily injuries so that he was rendered sick, sore, lame and disabled and so remains and was and will be compelled to seek medical aid and attention and incur expenses for same in an endeavor to cure himself of his said injuries and he was and will be prevented from attending his usual occupation and duties.

43. That at all times hereinafter mentioned the actions of CITY, NYPD, QUERY, DOE and ROE as described above were carried out in a reckless, deliberate, willful, wanton, malicious and grossly negligent manner.

44. That by reason of the foregoing, Plaintiff **DEREK THOMAS** has been damaged in an amount that exceeds the jurisdictional limits of all lower trial courts of this state.

**AS AND FOR A FOURTH CAUSE OF ACTION ON BEHALF OF
PLAINTIFF DEREK THOMAS**

45. Plaintiff **DEREK THOMAS** repeats, reiterates and realleges each and every allegation contained in paragraphs numbered 1 – 44 with the same force and effect as if fully set forth at length herein.

46. That the CITY, NYPD, their agents, servants and employees were negligent, careless and reckless in hiring, retaining, training, monitoring, retraining, supervising and promoting its employees including but not limited to QUERY, DOE and ROE, in that said police officers, as employees of CITY and NYPD, were not qualified to be hired or retained or promoted as police officers, lacked the experience, skill, training and ability to be employed, retained and utilized in the manner that each was employed by CITY and NYPD.

47. That the CITY and NYPD failed to exercise due care and caution in its hiring, retaining, training and/or promoting practices in that CITY and NYPD failed to adequately test,

analyze test results, and/or investigate above mentioned police officers backgrounds and performances.

48. That the CITY and NYPD failed to exercise due care and caution in its hiring, retaining, training and/or promoting practices in that CITY and NYPD failed to adequately screen said police officers, failed to adequately monitor said police officers, and failed to adequately discipline said police officers when they violate Patrol Guidelines.

49. Defendant CITY and NYPD were also negligent in that prior to and at the time of the acts complained of herein, due to the prior history of the police officer defendants named herein, knew or should have known of the bad disposition of said defendants, or at the very least had knowledge of facts that would put a reasonably prudent employer on inquiry concerning their bad disposition and the fact that defendant police officers were not suitable to be hired and employed by the CITY and NYPD and that due to their lack of training, these officers should have had adequate supervision so that they would not arrest innocent individuals nor use excessive force during the arrest process.

50. That by reason of the above, the Plaintiff **DEREK THOMAS** was injured in mind and body as he was arrested, prosecuted and rendered sick, sore, and damaged.

51. That at all times hereinafter mentioned the actions of CITY, NYPD and all defendants herein as described above were carried out in a reckless, deliberate, willful, wanton, malicious and grossly negligent manner.

52. That by reason of the foregoing, Plaintiff **DEREK THOMAS** has been damaged in an amount that exceeds the jurisdictional limits of all lower trial courts of this state.

**AS AND FOR A FIFTH CAUSE OF ACTION ON BEHALF OF
PLAINTIFF DEREK THOMAS**

53. Plaintiff **DEREK THOMAS** repeats, reiterates and realleges each and every

allegation contained in paragraphs numbered 1-52 with the same force and effect as if fully set forth at length herein.

54. In arresting Plaintiff **DEREK THOMAS**, police officers including but not limited to QUERY, DOE and ROE, acting in their capacity as agents, servants and employees of CITY and NYPD, were motivated by an ulterior purpose to do harm, without justification or economic or social excuse.

55. In arresting Plaintiff **DEREK THOMAS**, police officers including but not limited to QUERY, DOE and ROE, acting in their capacity as agents, servants and employees of CITY and NYPD, sought either a detriment to Plaintiff **DEREK THOMAS** or a collateral advantage to the CITY and NYPD that is outside the legitimate ends of effectuating an arrest.

56. As a result of the abuse of process by defendants herein, Plaintiff **DEREK THOMAS** sustained multiple injuries including but not limited to loss of liberty, emotional distress, humiliation, loss of enjoyment of life, and fear and intimidation for his safety.

57. That at all times hereinafter mentioned the actions of CITY, NYPD and all defendants herein as described above were carried out in a reckless, deliberate, willful, wanton, malicious and grossly negligent manner.

58. That by reason of the foregoing, Plaintiff **DEREK THOMAS** has been damaged in an amount that exceeds the jurisdictional limits of all lower trial courts of this state.

AS AND FOR A SIXTH CAUSE OF ACTION ON BEHALF OF
PLAINTIFF DEREK THOMAS

59. Plaintiff **DEREK THOMAS** repeats, reiterates and realleges each and every allegation contained in paragraphs numbered 1 - 58 with the same force and effect as if fully set forth at length herein.

60. That on 12/31/23, at approximately 8:00 p.m., within the vicinity of Willis Avenue and

East 138th Street, County of Bronx, City and State of New York, the CITY and NYPD were present through its agents, servants and/or employees including but not limited to QUERY, DOE and ROE, who were acting in the course of their employment and under the color of law to wit: the statutes, ordinances and regulations, policies and customs and usage of the State of New York and/or City of New York.

61. That Plaintiff **DEREK THOMAS** was lawfully in the above vicinity at the above time when he was stopped, questioned, searched and seized solely on the basis of his age and/or race and for no legal or legitimate reason.

62. That said illegal stop and seizure was part of the CITY'S custom and practice and/or practice of racial profiling, and/or meeting arrest or summons quotas, and/or the illegal stop and search of civilians which was authorized by, or met with the tacit approval of the CITY and NYPD under their "Stop, Question and Frisk" policy or program ("Stop and Frisk").

63. That under the "Stop and Frisk" program the CITY and NYPD permitted, condoned, or acted with deliberate indifference to the racial disparity of its' application, to the fact that unnecessary or illegal frisks or searches were conducted, that very low percentages of seizures, frisks and searches resulted in arrests or the recovery of contraband, that pretextual reasons are provided for "Stop and Frisk", that officers do not always fill out Stop and Frisk reports, i.e. UF-250s, and are not disciplined when they fail to do so, that stop and frisks are conducted without reasonable suspicion, and that the program of "Stop and Frisk" has resulted in illegal stops, seizures, frisks, arrests and the use of physical force.

64. That the CITY and NYPD have failed to discipline, train, monitor or retrain offending police officers who engaged in stops and frisks without any legal justification and has failed to discipline police officers who fail to fill out required UF-250s.

65. That the CITY and NYPD have failed to adequately investigate and/or discipline officers who use excessive force, stop and frisk innocent citizens who have not done anything illegal or acted in suspicious manner warranting a seizure, who failed to report misconduct of fellow officers, who destroy evidence, who engage in fraud, misrepresentations, deceit, and maliciously participate in and instigate prosecutions of innocent citizens.

66. It is alleged herein that Plaintiff **DEREK THOMAS** was stopped and seized absent reasonable suspicion. That said actions of defendants were pursuant to an illegal and improper Stop and Frisk program that was promulgated by defendants. That such custom, policy and program has created a class of citizens, including Plaintiff **DEREK THOMAS**, who have been illegally stopped and seized, searched and questioned based on their race, and in order to meet arrest quotas. Evidence of said policy is as follows:

a. That in a class action lawsuit David Floyd, et. al. v. City of New York, et. al., pending in United States District Court, Southern District of New York, 08 CIV 1034, in a decision dated 5/16/12 certifying a class action lawsuit, it was found that between the years of 2005 and 2009 a reported 2.8 million people in New York City have been stopped and frisked. Of said number more than 87% were minority citizens. Summons and arrests were issued or made in approximately 10% of the reported stops. Meaning that based on their own records, defendants' suspicions are incorrect approximately 9 out of 10 stops.

b. The Honorable Shira A. Scheindlin, found in the Floyd decision that:

- i. It is indisputable that NYPD has an enormous Stop and Frisk program;
- ii. Evidence shows that the Stop and Frisk program is organized and hierarchical;
- iii. Stop and Frisk program has been designed and revised at highest levels of defendants;

- iv. The implementation of the program is conducted according to uniform and centralized rules;
- v. Monitoring of the program is hierarchical;
- vi. The program is the result of institutional decisions and directives.

c. Justice Sheindlin further found that a preponderance of evidence shows that defendants policy of establishing performance standards and demanding increased levels of stop and frisks results in putative class of aggrieved citizens. The Court noted that street level stops have risen every year. That in 2004, defendants documented 313,000 stops, and in 2011 they reported 684,000 stops. In a Police Officer Performance Objectives Operation Order dated 10/17/11, Commissioner Kelly directed that “Department managers can and must set performance goals – relating to “the issuance of summons, the stopping and questioning of suspicious individuals and the arrests of criminals.” It further states that “uniformed members who do not demonstrate activities . . . or who fail to engage in proactive activities . . . will be evaluated accordingly and their assignments reassessed.”

67. Other instances of an illegal and/or improper stop and frisk program custom or practice and/or excessive use of force and filing of false charges includes but not limited to:

a. On 4/12/11 in the vicinity of Walton Avenue and Mt. Hope Place, Bronx, NY, while doing nothing illegal or improper, Lonnie Thompson was approached by several uniformed police officers for no reason and without reasonable suspicion. After being stopped, Mr. Thompson was patted down and searched. He was arrested and charged with Criminal Possession of a Weapon in the Fourth Degree. This, even though the weapon was a bona fide work tool. Mr. Thompson was subjected to a strip search at the 46th Precinct. All charges were dismissed.

b. On 5/4/11 in the vicinity of 2345 Jerome Avenue, Bronx, NY, Alexis Niewkerk, who is

handicapped, was sitting in his legally parked vehicle and waiting for his friends to finish shopping at a nearby store. All of a sudden several undercover police officers from Bronx Narcotics approached his vehicle for no reason and without reasonable suspicion ordered him out of said vehicle. Mr. Niewkerk was subjected to a pat down and search. He was subsequently arrested for possession of a controlled substance in the seventh degree even though the “substance” recovered from his pants pocket was his own prescribed pain medication. Mr. Niewkerk was subjected to a strip search and forced to move his body in ways that are extremely painful given his medical status and condition. All charges were dismissed.

c. On 6/2/11 in the vicinity of 985 Simpson Street, Bronx, NY, Jesus Rosario, an infant, was approached by several police officers from the 41st Precinct. He was told to “get on the wall” and thereafter patted down and searched. Mr. Rosario was accused of Trespassing in the Second Degree. Mr. Rosario was doing nothing illegal or improper at the time the officers approached as he was simply exiting 985 Simpson Street after visiting his father who resides in said building. After being arrested, Mr. Rosario was subjected to a strip search at the 41st Precinct. The case was declined to be prosecuted by the District Attorney’s Office.

d. On 8/1/12 in the vicinity of Willis Avenue and East 138th Street, Bronx, NY Nicholas Hernandez and MIGUEL TAVERAS were sitting outside of their building on a public bench and doing nothing illegal or improper. All of a sudden, several police officers from the 41st Precinct approached them for no reason and told them to submit to a frisk. Mr. Hernandez and Mr. Pena were accused of possession of marihuana even though no marihuana was recovered. They were each subjected to a strip search at the 41st Precinct. All charges against them were declined to be prosecuted by the District Attorney’s Office.

e. On 1/22/11 in the vicinity of 808 Park Avenue, Brooklyn, NY, Captain Michelle Culp,

a now retired Captain for New York City Department of Corrections, was visiting her sick and elderly mother at the aforementioned address and decided to walk her mother's dog. In so doing, Captain Culp was approached by several uniform housing police officers and accused of Trespassing in the Second Degree. She was patted down and searched. This, despite the fact that Captain Culp explained that she was visiting her mother and her identification and personal belongings were in her mother's apartment in the same building. All charges were dismissed.

f. On 5/20/11 in the vicinity of Park Avenue and East 138th Street, Bronx, NY, Patrick Nielson was exiting the number 4 subway train and going to his car which was parked nearby when he was followed, stopped, frisked, and assaulted by several undercover police officers from Bronx Narcotics for no reason. Thereafter, he was arrested and accused of possession of a controlled substance. Mr. Nielson was subjected to a strip search. The "controlled" substance was Mr. Nielson's prescribed medicine. All charges were dismissed.

g. On 6/22/10 in the vicinity of 139th Street and Lenox Avenue, New York, NY, Wilford Person was approached by several undercover police officers from Manhattan North Narcotics for no legitimate reason. Mr. Person was thereafter told to get against a fence and patted down and searched. He was accused of possession of marihuana. Mr. Person was simply playing basketball at the time the police approached him. After being arrested and subjected to a strip search Mr. Person was prosecuted. All charges were eventually dismissed.

h. On 5/2/12 in the vicinity of 1912 Third Avenue, New York, NY, Jose Baez, the manager of a local eyeglass store, left the store to buy his lunch. After leaving the store Mr. Baez, for no reason at all, was approached by several undercover police officers from Manhattan North Narcotics, and was detained, patted down, searched, and falsely accused of selling marihuana. Mr. Baez was subjected to a strip search. All charges against him were dismissed.

i. On 11/13/10 in the vicinity of 1113 Boston Road, Bronx, NY, Alpha Mahoi, was doing nothing illegal or improper when, for no reason, he was approached by several undercover police officers from Bronx Narcotics and accused of being involved in the sale of cocaine. He was cuffed, patted down, searched, arrested and strip searched at the precinct. All charges were dismissed.

j. On 3/10/12 in the vicinity of 1821 Davison Avenue, Bronx, NY, Keyewanie Blackledge, Dwayne Smith and Richard Campbell were leaving his friend's apartment when they were approached by several uniform police officers from the 46th Precinct for no reason and told to "get on the wall" and "get on the floor" and thereafter patted down and searched. They was charged with Trespassing in the Second Degree. All charges were dismissed.

k. On 8/1/12 in the vicinity of Willis Avenue and East 138th Street, Bronx, NY, Dylan Pena was outside recording on his cell phone several police officers from the 41st Precinct arresting a person from the neighborhood. Upon seeing Mr. Pena recording the incident several police officers grabbed him and pushed him to the ground and seized his cell phone without any reason to do so. All data on the phone was subsequently erased by the officers. Mr. Pena was also patted down and searched. He was charged with resisting arrest and was strip searched at the 41st Precinct. The charges were declined to be prosecuted by the District Attorney's Office.

l. On 5/17/11 in the vicinity of 1690 Clay Avenue, Bronx, NY, Gregory Williams was leaving a family friend's apartment after helping her move furniture so she could clean. Upon exiting the building Mr. Williams, for no reason at all, was approached by several uniformed police officers from the 44th Precinct and patted down and searched. He was accused of Trespassing in the Second Degree despite his family friend informing the police officers at the scene and at the 44th Precinct that he had permission to be in the building. Mr. Williams was strip searched. All charges against him were dismissed.

m. On 3/16/11 in the vicinity of 1740 Grand Avenue, Bronx, NY, Lindon Grant just left his apartment to walk approximately 1 block to buy breakfast before going to work. After he bought his breakfast and left the store he was approached by several undercover police officers from the 46th Precinct for no reason and patted down and searched. He was then accused of selling marihuana. Mr. Grant was arrested, strip searched and prosecuted for several months. All charges were dismissed.

n. On 8/2/09 in the vicinity of Southern Boulevard and East 175th Street, Bronx, NY Jose Suazo was approached by several uniformed officers from the 42nd Precinct for no reason. Mr. Suazo was patted down and searched. Despite the fact that he had nothing illegal on his person he was charged with possession of marihuana. While already in custody in a police van shots were fired in a nearby park. When Mr. Suazo got to the precinct he found out that even though he was already in custody in the police van when the shots were fired, he was charged with possession of a weapon in the second degree. Mr. Suazo was subjected to a strip search. All charges were eventually dismissed.

o. On 8/12/19 in the vicinity of 894 Rogers Place, Bronx, NY, Edmanuel Benitez was standing outside of the building and waiting for a friend to come outside to play basketball. All of a sudden he was approached for no reason by officers from the 41st Precinct and thereafter patted down, searched, arrested, strip searched and prosecuted for the sale of marihuana. All charges were dismissed.

p. On 2/19/12 Daniel Rodriguez was leaving a store in the vicinity of Jerome Avenue and West 192nd Street when he was summarily grabbed, pushed against a wall, patted down, frisked, searched and then handcuffed by several officers from Bronx Narcotics. Mr. Rodriguez was doing nothing illegal or improper at the time. He was subsequently strip searched and charged with

possession of a controlled substance in the seventh degree. All charges were dismissed.

q. On 9/28/11 Shakeem Enang was in the vicinity of West 179th Street and University Avenue when he was approached by several plain clothes officers from Bronx Narcotics Division. Mr. Enang was doing nothing illegal at the time the officers approached or any time prior to the officers approaching. He was grabbed, seized, frisked, searched and then arrested. Mr. Enang was charged with criminal sale of a controlled substance. He was strip searched at the 46th Precinct. All charges were dismissed.

68. As is evidence from the above, Plaintiff **DEREK THOMAS'** injuries including the violation of his constitutional rights, the deprivation of his freedom, falsely and maliciously being prosecuted, physical and emotional injuries, are the direct and proximate result of the CITY'S and NYPD'S policies and/or deliberate indifference to practices which involve the excessive use of force, false arrest, police cover-ups, witness intimidation, malicious prosecution, illegal stop, questions and frisks, searches, Fourth Amendment violations, and deliberate indifference to the need to train, supervise, monitor, investigate and discipline, including suspension, dismissal and/or reassignment offending police officers. The practice is widespread and pervasive throughout the entire City of New York.

69. The CITY and NYPD knew or should have known of the customs and police practices of its officers which included but was not limited to: the failing to preserve and/or destruction of exculpatory evidence, threatening to arrest witnesses to police misconduct and engaging in cover-ups, fraud, perjury, deceit and malfeasance.

70. That the acts of employees of the CITY and NYPD, i.e. police officers, who violate the civil and constitutional rights of the citizens of the City of New York routinely go unreported, undisciplined and their acts condoned by other officers, including their supervisors. Upon

information and belief, the supervisors of defendant police officers herein were aware of the conduct of defendant police officers and failed to stop, report or intervene in the misconduct.

71. The CITY and NYPD'S tolerance for brutality, excessive force, illegal and/or retaliatory arrests, and their emphasis to come down hard on quality of life infractions leads to a systemic practice and policy wherein police officers seem fairly tolerant of police brutality, silence in the face of brutality and/or illegal stops, frisks, searches, seizures and/or arrests, and engage in the practice of meeting arrest quotas. A systemic practice where officers who report said misconduct are not viewed as "good cops" but rather as outcasts and are ostracized and often transferred to other assignments thereby perpetuating the illegal conduct of the NYPD and thusly the CITY.

72. Some instances where officers were treated as outcasts for reporting misconduct and/or arrest/summons quota system are as follows:

a. The existence of arrest quotas, summons quotas and approval of illegal stops and arrests have been exposed by Police officer Adrian Schoolcraft in a separate lawsuit which was cited by Justice Sheindlin in Floyd.

b. Justice Sheindlin referenced the deposition of Police Officer Adhjlly Polanco of the 41st Precinct stating that commanding officers set specific quotas for arrests and summons and for stop and frisks and threatened to reduce overtime for officers who failed to perform well and re-assign those who fail to meet quotas to less desirable posts.

c. According to secretly tape recorded conversations made by Schoolcraft, a Lieutenant, a Deputy Inspector and Chief of transportation can be heard encouraging and demanding increased stops, summons and detentions and arrests.

d. Police Officer Craig Lance of the 42nd Precinct filed a lawsuit against the NYPD claiming the existence of a quota system and a systematic retaliation and harassment to those who

did not comply.

e. Retired Detective James Griffin filed a lawsuit claiming that in the NYPD there exists a culture wherein officers who report corruption will face harassment and a hostile work environment and that this conduct was tolerated by supervisors within the NYPD.

f. Police Officer Minoia, an officer with an Ivy League degree, assigned to the 42nd Precinct, was reassigned to a “punishment post” due to the fact that he failed to write a sufficient amount of summons and stated “I’m not going to pull out my summons book and write a summons because my boss is telling me he’s going to make it difficult for me if I don’t.”

73. In sum, the CITY and NYPD are responsible for creating a custom, policy or practice wherein many officers do not seem to believe that anything is really wrong with stopping and searching innocent citizens or using unnecessary or excessive force or falsely arresting citizens to meet an arrest quota.

74. That the above customs, policies and/or practices and the deliberate indifference thereto, was a direct and proximate cause of the illegal seizure of Plaintiff **DEREK THOMAS**, the excessive use of force on Plaintiff, and the false arrest and malicious prosecution of Plaintiff. The CITY and NYPD’S policies, customs and/or practices deprived the Plaintiff of his rights and liberties as set forth in the Constitutions of the United States and the State of New York and under 42 U.S.C §§ 1983, 1986 and 1988.

75. That said actions violated the Fourth and Fourteenth Amendments to the Constitution of the United States, violated Plaintiff’s right to be secure in person, and that the defendants used excessive, unnecessary and unlawful force, which constituted cruel and inhumane treatment and denied him due process of law.

76. Moreover, the CITY and NYPD caused or created a policy and/or custom, and acted

with deliberate indifference to patterns and/or police practices which included illegal seizures, excessive or arbitrary use of force, illegal use of police equipment, destruction of evidence, intimidation of witnesses, illegal arrests, failing to gather evidence when allegations of police misconduct are involved, condoning a code of silence within the NYPD regarding misconduct, failing to take police reports of illegal conduct, failing to properly supervise, train, investigate or discipline officers, and any and/or all of the above have contributed to Plaintiff's false arrest, malicious and false prosecution, and injuries.

77. That the Plaintiff did not commit any illegal act, either before or at the time he was falsely arrested and imprisoned, assaulted, battered and deprived of his constitutional rights as set forth in the Constitution of the United States and 42 U.S.C § 1983.

78. That by reason of the foregoing, Plaintiff **DEREK THOMAS** has been damaged in an amount that exceeds the jurisdictional limits of all lower trial courts of this state.

**AS AND FOR A SEVENTH CAUSE OF ACTION ON BEHALF OF
PLAINTIFF DEREK THOMAS**

79. Plaintiff **DEREK THOMAS** repeats, reiterates and realleges each and every allegation contained in paragraphs numbered 1 - 78 with the same force and effect as if fully set forth at length herein.

80. At all times mentioned herein and above, defendants CITY and NYPD employed QUERY, DOE and ROE as police officers and named defendants were acting under color of law, to wit: the statutes, ordinances and regulations, policies and customs and usage of the State of New York and/or City of New York.

81. Plaintiff **DEREK THOMAS** is and at all times relevant herein, a citizen of the United States and a resident of Bronx County in the State of New York and brings this cause of action pursuant to 42 United States Code, Section 1983 and 42 United States Code, Section 1988.

82. That on or about 12/31/23, defendants CITY, NYPD, QUERY, DOE and ROE, without probable cause, reasonable cause or legal justification and while effectuating the seizure of plaintiff **DEREK THOMAS**, did search, seize, assault and commit a battery and grab the Plaintiff **DEREK THOMAS** without a court authorized arrest warrant or search warrant and defendants did physically seize Plaintiff **DEREK THOMAS** during the arrest process in an unlawful and excessive manner. Plaintiff **DEREK THOMAS** was falsely arrested, unlawfully imprisoned and searched and as a result of defendants' conduct maliciously prosecuted without the defendants possessing probable cause, reasonable cause or legal justification to do so.

83. The above actions of defendants CITY, NYPD, QUERY, DOE and ROE resulted in Plaintiff **DEREK THOMAS** being deprived of the following rights under the United States Constitution: a) Freedom from assault to his person; b) Freedom from battery to his person; c) Freedom from illegal search and seizure; d) Freedom from false arrest; e) Freedom from malicious prosecution; f) Freedom from the use of excessive force during the arrest process; and g) The right to Due Process of Law.

84. In addition to the above, defendants CITY and NYPD have as a matter of policy, custom and practice and with deliberate indifference failed to adequately train, monitor, supervise, discipline, sanction or otherwise direct its police officers, including the officers involved in this case and any and all unnamed officers involved in the unlawful seizure and arrest of plaintiff, regarding the protection of the constitutional rights of citizens.

85. Defendants CITY, NYPD, QUERY, DOE and ROE, subjected Plaintiff **DEREK THOMAS** to such deprivation in a malicious, reckless, deliberate, intentional, grossly negligent and with a callous disregard of Plaintiff **DEREK THOMAS**' rights and with deliberate indifference to those rights under the Fourth, Fifth, Sixth, Fourteenth and all other related Amendments to the

United States Constitution.

86. The direct and proximate result of the defendants CITY, NYPD, QUERY, DOE and ROE acts are that Plaintiff **DEREK THOMAS** has suffered severe and permanent injuries, loss of liberty and companionship, forced to endure pain and suffering, emotional distress and severe and significant damage to standing and reputation in the community.

87. That by reason of the foregoing, Plaintiff **DEREK THOMAS** has been damaged in an amount that exceeds the jurisdictional limits of all lower trial courts of this state.

AS AND FOR A EIGHTH CAUSE OF ACTION ON BEHALF OF
PLAINTIFF CURTIS SMALLWOOD

88. Plaintiff **CURTIS SMALLWOOD** repeats, reiterates and realleges each and every allegation contained in paragraphs numbered 1 – 87 with the same force and effect as if fully set forth at length herein.

89. That at all times the Plaintiff **CURTIS SMALLWOOD** was and is a resident of County of the Bronx, City, and State of New York.

90. That on 12/31/23, at approximately 8:00 p.m., Plaintiff **CURTIS SMALLWOOD** was lawfully in the vicinity of Willis Avenue and East 138th Street, County of Bronx, State of New York and doing nothing illegal, improper or acting suspicious in anyway.

91. That on 12/31/23, at approximately 8:00 p.m., in the vicinity of Willis Avenue and East 138th Street, County of Bronx, State of New York, QUERY, DOE and ROE, absent an arrest warrant, probable cause, reasonable cause or any legal justification, approached Plaintiff **CURTIS SMALLWOOD** for no reason and summarily stopped, frisked, searched, grabbed, assaulted, battered, and detained him in an aggressive and excessive manner.

92. Upon information and belief QUERY, DOE and ROE knew or had reason to know that their actions lacked any legal justification in approaching, searching, seizing and arresting

Plaintiff **CURTIS SMALLWOOD**.

93. That Plaintiff **CURTIS SMALLWOOD** was arraigned after his arrest and thereafter falsely and maliciously prosecuted with committing a crime or crimes.

94. Thereafter, Plaintiff **CURTIS SMALLWOOD** remained incarcerated for over 24 hours and was required to make numerous court appearances over an extended period of time until all charges against him were terminated favorably.

95. Plaintiff **CURTIS SMALLWOOD** sustained physical and emotional pain and injuries as a result of this incident.

96. That within ninety (90) days after the causes of actions accrued herein, and more than thirty (30) days prior to the commencement of this action, the Plaintiff **CURTIS SMALLWOOD** caused the notice of claim, in writing, sworn to by and on behalf of the claimants, the Plaintiff herein, containing the statement of the name and place of residence of the claimants by the street and number and their attorney, and describing the time when the particular claim and circumstances under which the damages and injuries were sustained, the cause thereof, and so far as practical, the nature and extent of the injuries to be personally served upon the defendant CITY, their agents, servants and/or employees at the Law Department,

97. This action was so commenced within one (1) year and ninety (90) days after said cause of action accrued herein, and for more than thirty (30) days prior to the commencement of this action, defendant CITY neglected, refused and failed to make an adjustment of said claim, and said claim remains unadjusted and unpaid, although plaintiff herein has requested and demanded that the same be paid and adjusted.

98. That more than thirty (30) days have elapsed since the service and filing of a Notice of Claim with the Comptroller of the City of New York and said entity has failed to schedule a

hearing pursuant to Section 50-h of the General Municipal Law. Plaintiff is ready, willing and able to submit to a 50-h examination if same is requested within a reasonable time frame from the filing of Notice of claim.

99. That on or about 12/31/23, at approximately 8:00 p.m., the Plaintiff **CURTIS SMALLWOOD** was without just cause, probable cause or provocation, and with reckless, negligent and callous disregard for the truth, and without investigation, touched, grabbed, handcuffed, seized and arrested in an excessive manner and with excessive force by CITY, NYPD, QUERY, DOE and ROE, their agents, servants and/or employees, and in particular, by QUERY, DOE and ROE.

100. That on or about 12/31/23, at approximately 8:00 p.m., the Plaintiff **CURTIS SMALLWOOD** while lawfully in the vicinity of Willis Avenue and East 138th Street, County of Bronx, City and State of New York, was without just cause, probable cause or provocation, maliciously, intentionally and falsely accused by CITY, NYPD, QUERY, DOE and ROE of having committed a crime or crimes.

101. That on or about 12/31/23, and upon arresting the Plaintiff **CURTIS SMALLWOOD** and depriving him of his liberty, CITY, NYPD, QUERY, DOE and ROE took the Plaintiff **CURTIS SMALLWOOD** to a police station in the County of Bronx and entered him on the records as under arrest.

102. That on or about 12/31/23, the CITY, NYPD, QUERY, DOE and ROE further caused Plaintiff **CURTIS SMALLWOOD** to have his fingerprints and photographs to be taken without his consent and in accordance with police procedures for the arrest of criminals and held him on various criminal charges at various police stations, correctional facilities and at the Courthouse located at 215 East 161st Street, County of Bronx, City and State of New York.

103. That on or about 12/31/23 Plaintiff **CURTIS SMALLWOOD** was aware of his arrest

and confinement, he did not consent to his arrest or confinement, and said confinement, seizure, arrest and detention was without legal justification.

104. That at all times hereinafter mentioned the actions of CITY, NYPD, QUERY, DOE and ROE as described above were carried out in a reckless, deliberate, willful, wanton, malicious and grossly negligent manner.

105. That by reason of the foregoing, Plaintiff **CURTIS SMALLWOOD** has been damaged in an amount that exceeds the jurisdictional limits of all lower trial courts of this state.

AS AND FOR A NINTH CAUSE OF ACTION ON BEHALF OF
PLAINTIFF CURTIS SMALLWOOD

106. Plaintiff **CURTIS SMALLWOOD** repeats, reiterates and realleges each and every allegation contained in paragraphs numbered 1 – 105 with the same force and effect as if fully set forth at length herein.

107. That on or about 12/31/23, a criminal complaint was issued by the CITY, NYPD, QUERY, DOE and ROE, their agents, servants and/or employees, without probable cause, reasonable cause or legal justification.

108. That on or about 12/31/23 a criminal action against Plaintiff **CURTIS SMALLWOOD** was commenced by CITY, NYPD, QUERY, DOE and ROE, their agents, servants and/or employees, without probable cause, reasonable cause or legal justification.

109. That solely as a result of the aforesaid, the Plaintiff **CURTIS SMALLWOOD'S** life was interfered with.

110. That the criminal action against Plaintiff **CURTIS SMALLWOOD** was continued for an extended period of time by defendants with malice and bad faith.

111. That solely as a result of the false arrest, assault, battery, false imprisonment and malicious prosecution of the Plaintiff **CURTIS SMALLWOOD**, he was deprived of his liberty for

an extended period of time and was subjected to scorn, ridicule, embarrassment and was degraded in the esteem of the community both personally and professionally.

112. That the criminal action against Plaintiff **CURTIS SMALLWOOD** was terminated favorably.

113. That the actions of CITY, NYPD, QUERY, DOE and ROE as described above were carried out in a reckless, deliberate, willful, wanton, malicious and grossly negligent manner.

114. That by reason of the foregoing, Plaintiff **CURTIS SMALLWOOD** has been damaged in an amount that exceeds the jurisdictional limits of all lower trial courts of this state.

**AS AND FOR A TENTH CAUSE OF ACTION ON BEHALF OF
PLAINTIFF CURTIS SMALLWOOD**

115. Plaintiff **CURTIS SMALLWOOD** repeats, reiterates and realleges each and every allegation contained in paragraphs numbered 1 – 114 with the same force and effect as if fully set forth at length herein.

116. That on or about 12/31/23, and while in the custody of the defendants in the County of Bronx, City of New York, the Plaintiff **CURTIS SMALLWOOD** was intentionally touched, pushed, assaulted, battered, violated, searched, humiliated, photographed and handcuffed by the CITY, NYPD, QUERY, DOE and ROE, who were acting within the scope of their employment and authority in such a manner as to knowingly cause injury to plaintiff.

117. That on or about 12/31/23 CITY, NYPD, QUERY, DOE and ROE, their agents, servants and employees, acting as agents and on behalf of the CITY, NYPD, QUERY, DOE and ROE, within the scope of their employment, did intentionally, willfully and maliciously assault and batter the Plaintiff **CURTIS SMALLWOOD** in that they have the real or apparent ability to cause imminent harmful and/or offensive bodily contact and intentionally did a violent and/or menacing act which threatened such contact to the Plaintiff **CURTIS SMALLWOOD** and their act caused

apprehension of such contact in the plaintiff, and in a hostile and/or offensive manner touched and beat the plaintiff and/or offensive bodily contact to the Plaintiff **CURTIS SMALLWOOD** and caused such battery in and about his head, neck, back, body and limbs.

118. That by reason of the aforesaid intentional assault and battery which was committed in an excessive manner and with excessive force and without legal justification or privilege by the defendants, their agents, servants and employees, who were acting within the scope of their employment and authority and without any probable or reasonable cause, Plaintiff **CURTIS SMALLWOOD** suffered great and permanent bodily injury in and about his head, neck, back, body and limbs and was rendered sick, sore, lame and disabled, and suffered conscious pain and suffering, and that he was otherwise damaged.

119. That as a result of the aforesaid assault and battery the Plaintiff **CURTIS SMALLWOOD** was caused to sustain serious, severe, painful and permanent bodily injuries so that he was rendered sick, sore, lame and disabled and so remains and was and will be compelled to seek medical aid and attention and incur expenses for same in an endeavor to cure himself of his said injuries and he was and will be prevented from attending his usual occupation and duties.

120. That at all times hereinafter mentioned the actions of CITY, NYPD, QUERY, DOE and ROE as described above were carried out in a reckless, deliberate, willful, wanton, malicious and grossly negligent manner.

121. That by reason of the foregoing, Plaintiff **CURTIS SMALLWOOD** has been damaged in an amount that exceeds the jurisdictional limits of all lower trial courts of this state.

**AS AND FOR A ELEVENTH CAUSE OF ACTION ON BEHALF OF
PLAINTIFF CURTIS SMALLWOOD**

122. Plaintiff **CURTIS SMALLWOOD** repeats, reiterates and realleges each and every allegation contained in paragraphs numbered 1 – 121 with the same force and effect as if fully set

forth at length herein.

123. That the CITY, NYPD, their agents, servants and employees were negligent, careless and reckless in hiring, retaining, training, monitoring, retraining, supervising and promoting its employees including but not limited to QUERY, DOE and ROE, in that said police officers, as employees of CITY and NYPD, were not qualified to be hired or retained or promoted as police officers, lacked the experience, skill, training and ability to be employed, retained and utilized in the manner that each was employed by CITY and NYPD.

124. That the CITY and NYPD failed to exercise due care and caution in its hiring, retaining, training and/or promoting practices in that CITY and NYPD failed to adequately test, analyze test results, and/or investigate above mentioned police officers backgrounds and performances.

125. That the CITY and NYPD failed to exercise due care and caution in its hiring, retaining, training and/or promoting practices in that CITY and NYPD failed to adequately screen said police officers, failed to adequately monitor said police officers, and failed to adequately discipline said police officers when they violate Patrol Guidelines.

126. Defendant CITY and NYPD were also negligent in that prior to and at the time of the acts complained of herein, due to the prior history of the police officer defendants named herein, knew or should have known of the bad disposition of said defendants, or at the very least had knowledge of facts that would put a reasonably prudent employer on inquiry concerning their bad disposition and the fact that defendant police officers were not suitable to be hired and employed by the CITY and NYPD and that due to their lack of training, these officers should have had adequate supervision so that they would not arrest innocent individuals nor use excessive force during the arrest process.

127. That by reason of the above, the Plaintiff **CURTIS SMALLWOOD** was injured in mind and body as he was arrested, prosecuted and rendered sick, sore, and damaged.

128. That at all times hereinafter mentioned the actions of CITY, NYPD and all defendants herein as described above were carried out in a reckless, deliberate, willful, wanton, malicious and grossly negligent manner.

129. That by reason of the foregoing, Plaintiff **CURTIS SMALLWOOD** has been damaged in an amount that exceeds the jurisdictional limits of all lower trial courts of this state.

AS AND FOR A TWELFTH CAUSE OF ACTION ON BEHALF OF
PLAINTIFF CURTIS SMALLWOOD

130. Plaintiff **CURTIS SMALLWOOD** repeats, reiterates and realleges each and every allegation contained in paragraphs numbered 1-129 with the same force and effect as if fully set forth at length herein.

131. In arresting Plaintiff **CURTIS SMALLWOOD**, police officers including but not limited to QUERY, DOE and ROE, acting in their capacity as agents, servants and employees of CITY and NYPD, were motivated by an ulterior purpose to do harm, without justification or economic or social excuse.

132. In arresting Plaintiff **CURTIS SMALLWOOD**, police officers including but not limited to QUERY, DOE and ROE, acting in their capacity as agents, servants and employees of CITY and NYPD, sought either a detriment to Plaintiff **CURTIS SMALLWOOD** or a collateral advantage to the CITY and NYPD that is outside the legitimate ends of effectuating an arrest.

133. As a result of the abuse of process by defendants herein, Plaintiff **CURTIS SMALLWOOD** sustained multiple injuries including but not limited to loss of liberty, emotional distress, humiliation, loss of enjoyment of life, and fear and intimidation for his safety.

134. That at all times hereinafter mentioned the actions of CITY, NYPD and all defendants

herein as described above were carried out in a reckless, deliberate, willful, wanton, malicious and grossly negligent manner.

135. That by reason of the foregoing, Plaintiff **CURTIS SMALLWOOD** has been damaged in an amount that exceeds the jurisdictional limits of all lower trial courts of this state.

**AS AND FOR A THIRTEENTH CAUSE OF ACTION ON BEHALF OF
PLAINTIFF CURTIS SMALLWOOD**

136. Plaintiff **CURTIS SMALLWOOD** repeats, reiterates and realleges each and every allegation contained in paragraphs numbered 1 - 135 with the same force and effect as if fully set forth at length herein.

137. That on 12/31/23, at approximately 8:00 p.m., within the vicinity of Willis Avenue and East 138th Street, County of Bronx, City and State of New York, the CITY and NYPD were present through its agents, servants and/or employees including but not limited to QUERY, DOE and ROE, who were acting in the course of their employment and under the color of law to wit: the statutes, ordinances and regulations, policies and customs and usage of the State of New York and/or City of New York.

138. That Plaintiff **CURTIS SMALLWOOD** was lawfully in the above vicinity at the above time when he was stopped, questioned, searched and seized solely on the basis of his age and/or race and for no legal or legitimate reason.

139. That said illegal stop and seizure was part of the CITY'S custom and practice and/or practice of racial profiling, and/or meeting arrest or summons quotas, and/or the illegal stop and search of civilians which was authorized by, or met with the tacit approval of the CITY and NYPD under their "Stop, Question and Frisk" policy or program ("Stop and Frisk").

140. That under the "Stop and Frisk" program the CITY and NYPD permitted, condoned, or acted with deliberate indifference to the racial disparity of its' application, to the fact that

unnecessary or illegal frisks or searches were conducted, that very low percentages of seizures, frisks and searches resulted in arrests or the recovery of contraband, that pretextual reasons are provided for “Stop and Frisk”, that officers do not always fill out Stop and Frisk reports, i.e. UF-250s, and are not disciplined when they fail to do so, that stop and frisks are conducted without reasonable suspicion, and that the program of “Stop and Frisk” has resulted in illegal stops, seizures, frisks, arrests and the use of physical force.

141. That the CITY and NYPD have failed to discipline, train, monitor or retrain offending police officers who engaged in stops and frisks without any legal justification and has failed to discipline police officers who fail to fill out required UF-250s.

142. That the CITY and NYPD have failed to adequately investigate and/or discipline officers who use excessive force, stop and frisk innocent citizens who have not done anything illegal or acted in suspicious manner warranting a seizure, who failed to report misconduct of fellow officers, who destroy evidence, who engage in fraud, misrepresentations, deceit, and maliciously participate in and instigate prosecutions of innocent citizens.

143. It is alleged herein that Plaintiff **CURTIS SMALLWOOD** was stopped and seized absent reasonable suspicion. That said actions of defendants were pursuant to an illegal and improper Stop and Frisk program that was promulgated by defendants. That such custom, policy and program has created a class of citizens, including Plaintiff **CURTIS SMALLWOOD**, who have been illegally stopped and seized, searched and questioned based on their race, and in order to meet arrest quotas. Evidence of said policy is as follows:

a. That in a class action lawsuit David Floyd, et. al. v. City of New York, et. al., pending in United States District Court, Southern District of New York, 08 CIV 1034, in a decision dated 5/16/12 certifying a class action lawsuit, it was found that between the years of 2005 and 2009 a

reported 2.8 million people in New York City have been stopped and frisked. Of said number more than 87% were minority citizens. Summons and arrests were issued or made in approximately 10% of the reported stops. Meaning that based on their own records, defendants' suspicions are incorrect approximately 9 out of 10 stops.

b. The Honorable Shira A. Scheindlin, found in the Floyd decision that:

- i. It is indisputable that NYPD has an enormous Stop and Frisk program;
- ii. Evidence shows that the Stop and Frisk program is organized and hierarchical;
- iii. Stop and Frisk program has been designed and revised at highest levels of defendants;
- iv. The implementation of the program is conducted according to uniform and centralized rules;
- v. Monitoring of the program is hierarchical;
- vi. The program is the result of institutional decisions and directives.

c. Justice Sheindlin further found that a preponderance of evidence shows that defendants policy of establishing performance standards and demanding increased levels of stop and frisks results in putative class of aggrieved citizens. The Court noted that street level stops have risen every year. That in 2004, defendants documented 313,000 stops, and in 2011 they reported 684,000 stops. In a Police Officer Performance Objectives Operation Order dated 10/17/11, Commissioner Kelly directed that "Department managers can and must set performance goals – relating to "the issuance of summons, the stopping and questioning of suspicious individuals and the arrests of criminals." It further states that "uniformed members who do not demonstrate activities . . . or who fail to engage in proactive activities . . . will be evaluated accordingly and their assignments reassessed."

144. Other instances of an illegal and/or improper stop and frisk program custom or practice and/or excessive use of force and filing of false charges includes but not limited to:

a. On 4/12/11 in the vicinity of Walton Avenue and Mt. Hope Place, Bronx, NY, while doing nothing illegal or improper, Lonnie Thompson was approached by several uniformed police officers for no reason and without reasonable suspicion. After being stopped, Mr. Thompson was patted down and searched. He was arrested and charged with Criminal Possession of a Weapon in the Fourth Degree. This, even though the weapon was a bona fide work tool. Mr. Thompson was subjected to a strip search at the 46th Precinct. All charges were dismissed.

b. On 5/4/11 in the vicinity of 2345 Jerome Avenue, Bronx, NY, Alexis Niewkerk, who is handicapped, was sitting in his legally parked vehicle and waiting for his friends to finish shopping at a nearby store. All of a sudden several undercover police officers from Bronx Narcotics approached his vehicle for no reason and without reasonable suspicion ordered him out of said vehicle. Mr. Niewkerk was subjected to a pat down and search. He was subsequently arrested for possession of a controlled substance in the seventh degree even though the "substance" recovered from his pants pocket was his own prescribed pain medication. Mr. Niewkerk was subjected to a strip search and forced to move his body in ways that are extremely painful given his medical status and condition. All charges were dismissed.

c. On 6/2/11 in the vicinity of 985 Simpson Street, Bronx, NY, Jesus Rosario, an infant, was approached by several police officers from the 41st Precinct. He was told to "get on the wall" and thereafter patted down and searched. Mr. Rosario was accused of Trespassing in the Second Degree. Mr. Rosario was doing nothing illegal or improper at the time the officers approached as he was simply exiting 985 Simpson Street after visiting his father who resides in said building. After being arrested, Mr. Rosario was subjected to a strip search at the 41st Precinct. The case was

declined to be prosecuted by the District Attorney's Office.

d. On 8/1/12 in the vicinity of Willis Avenue and East 138th Street, Bronx, NY Nicholas Hernandez and MIGUEL TAVERAS were sitting outside of their building on a public bench and doing nothing illegal or improper. All of a sudden, several police officers from the 41st Precinct approached them for no reason and told them to submit to a frisk. Mr. Hernandez and Mr. Pena were accused of possession of marihuana even though no marihuana was recovered. They were each subjected to a strip search at the 41st Precinct. All charges against them were declined to be prosecuted by the District Attorney's Office.

e. On 1/22/11 in the vicinity of 808 Park Avenue, Brooklyn, NY, Captain Michelle Culp, a now retired Captain for New York City Department of Corrections, was visiting her sick and elderly mother at the aforementioned address and decided to walk her mother's dog. In so doing, Captain Culp was approached by several uniform housing police officers and accused of Trespassing in the Second Degree. She was patted down and searched. This, despite the fact that Captain Culp explained that she was visiting her mother and her identification and personal belongings were in her mother's apartment in the same building. All charges were dismissed.

f. On 5/20/11 in the vicinity of Park Avenue and East 138th Street, Bronx, NY, Patrick Nielson was exiting the number 4 subway train and going to his car which was parked nearby when he was followed, stopped, frisked, and assaulted by several undercover police officers from Bronx Narcotics for no reason. Thereafter, he was arrested and accused of possession of a controlled substance. Mr. Nielson was subjected to a strip search. The "controlled" substance was Mr. Nielson's prescribed medicine. All charges were dismissed.

g. On 6/22/10 in the vicinity of 139th Street and Lenox Avenue, New York, NY, Wilford Person was approached by several undercover police officers from Manhattan North Narcotics for

no legitimate reason. Mr. Person was thereafter told to get against a fence and patted down and searched. He was accused of possession of marihuana. Mr. Person was simply playing basketball at the time the police approached him. After being arrested and subjected to a strip search Mr. Person was prosecuted. All charges were eventually dismissed.

h. On 5/2/12 in the vicinity of 1912 Third Avenue, New York, NY, Jose Baez, the manager of a local eyeglass store, left the store to buy his lunch. After leaving the store Mr. Baez, for no reason at all, was approached by several undercover police officers from Manhattan North Narcotics, and was detained, patted down, searched, and falsely accused of selling marihuana. Mr. Baez was subjected to a strip search. All charges against him were dismissed.

i. On 11/13/10 in the vicinity of 1113 Boston Road, Bronx, NY, Alpha Mahoi, was doing nothing illegal or improper when, for no reason, he was approached by several undercover police officers from Bronx Narcotics and accused of being involved in the sale of cocaine. He was cuffed, patted down, searched, arrested and strip searched at the precinct. All charges were dismissed.

j. On 3/10/12 in the vicinity of 1821 Davison Avenue, Bronx, NY, Keyewanie Blackledge, Dwayne Smith and Richard Campbell were leaving his friend's apartment when they were approached by several uniform police officers from the 46th Precinct for no reason and told to "get on the wall" and "get on the floor" and thereafter patted down and searched. They was charged with Trespassing in the Second Degree. All charges were dismissed.

k. On 8/1/12 in the vicinity of Willis Avenue and East 138th Street, Bronx, NY, Dylan Pena was outside recording on his cell phone several police officers from the 41st Precinct arresting a person from the neighborhood. Upon seeing Mr. Pena recording the incident several police officers grabbed him and pushed him to the ground and seized his cell phone without any reason to do so. All data on the phone was subsequently erased by the officers. Mr. Pena was also patted down and

searched. He was charged with resisting arrest and was strip searched at the 41st Precinct. The charges were declined to be prosecuted by the District Attorney's Office.

l. On 5/17/11 in the vicinity of 1690 Clay Avenue, Bronx, NY, Gregory Williams was leaving a family friend's apartment after helping her move furniture so she could clean. Upon exiting the building Mr. Williams, for no reason at all, was approached by several uniformed police officers from the 44th Precinct and patted down and searched. He was accused of Trespassing in the Second Degree despite his family friend informing the police officers at the scene and at the 44th Precinct that he had permission to be in the building. Mr. Williams was strip searched. All charges against him were dismissed.

m. On 3/16/11 in the vicinity of 1740 Grand Avenue, Bronx, NY, Lindon Grant just left his apartment to walk approximately 1 block to buy breakfast before going to work. After he bought his breakfast and left the store he was approached by several undercover police officers from the 46th Precinct for no reason and patted down and searched. He was then accused of selling marihuana. Mr. Grant was arrested, strip searched and prosecuted for several months. All charges were dismissed.

n. On 8/2/09 in the vicinity of Southern Boulevard and East 175th Street, Bronx, NY Jose Suazo was approached by several uniformed officers from the 42nd Precinct for no reason. Mr. Suazo was patted down and searched. Despite the fact that he had nothing illegal on his person he was charged with possession of marihuana. While already in custody in a police van shots were fired in a nearby park. When Mr. Suazo got to the precinct he found out that even though he was already in custody in the police van when the shots were fired, he was charged with possession of a weapon in the second degree. Mr. Suazo was subjected to a strip search. All charges were eventually dismissed.

o. On 8/12/19 in the vicinity of 894 Rogers Place, Bronx, NY, Edmanuel Benitez was standing outside of the building and waiting for a friend to come outside to play basketball. All of a sudden he was approached for no reason by officers from the 41st Precinct and thereafter patted down, searched, arrested, strip searched and prosecuted for the sale of marihuana. All charges were dismissed.

p. On 2/19/12 Daniel Rodriguez was leaving a store in the vicinity of Jerome Avenue and West 192nd Street when he was summarily grabbed, pushed against a wall, patted down, frisked, searched and then handcuffed by several officers from Bronx Narcotics. Mr. Rodriguez was doing nothing illegal or improper at the time. He was subsequently strip searched and charged with possession of a controlled substance in the seventh degree. All charges were dismissed.

q. On 9/28/11 Shakeem Enang was in the vicinity of West 179th Street and University Avenue when he was approached by several plain clothes officers from Bronx Narcotics Division. Mr. Enang was doing nothing illegal at the time the officers approached or any time prior to the officers approaching. He was grabbed, seized, frisked, searched and then arrested. Mr. Enang was charged with criminal sale of a controlled substance. He was strip searched at the 46th Precinct. All charges were dismissed.

145. As is evidence from the above, Plaintiff **CURTIS SMALLWOOD'S** injuries including the violation of his constitutional rights, the deprivation of his freedom, falsely and maliciously being prosecuted, physical and emotional injuries, are the direct and proximate result of the CITY'S and NYPD'S policies and/or deliberate indifference to practices which involve the excessive use of force, false arrest, police cover-ups, witness intimidation, malicious prosecution, illegal stop, questions and frisks, searches, Fourth Amendment violations, and deliberate indifference to the need to train, supervise, monitor, investigate and discipline, including suspension, dismissal and/or

reassignment offending police officers. The practice is widespread and pervasive throughout the entire City of New York.

146. The CITY and NYPD knew or should have known of the customs and police practices of its officers which included but was not limited to: the failing to preserve and/or destruction of exculpatory evidence, threatening to arrest witnesses to police misconduct and engaging in cover-ups, fraud, perjury, deceit and malfeasance.

147. That the acts of employees of the CITY and NYPD, i.e. police officers, who violate the civil and constitutional rights of the citizens of the City of New York routinely go unreported, undisciplined and their acts condoned by other officers, including their supervisors. Upon information and belief, the supervisors of defendant police officers herein were aware of the conduct of defendant police officers and failed to stop, report or intervene in the misconduct.

148. The CITY and NYPD'S tolerance for brutality, excessive force, illegal and/or retaliatory arrests, and their emphasis to come down hard on quality of life infractions leads to a systemic practice and policy wherein police officers seem fairly tolerant of police brutality, silence in the face of brutality and/or illegal stops, frisks, searches, seizures and/or arrests, and engage in the practice of meeting arrest quotas. A systemic practice where officers who report said misconduct are not viewed as "good cops" but rather as outcasts and are ostracized and often transferred to other assignments thereby perpetuating the illegal conduct of the NYPD and thusly the CITY.

149. Some instances where officers were treated as outcasts for reporting misconduct and/or arrest/summons quota system are as follows:

a. The existence of arrest quotas, summons quotas and approval of illegal stops and arrests have been exposed by Police officer Adrian Schoolcraft in a separate lawsuit which was cited by Justice Sheindlin in Floyd.

b. Justice Sheindlin referenced the deposition of Police Officer Adhily Polanco of the 41st Precinct stating that commanding officers set specific quotas for arrests and summons and for stop and frisks and threatened to reduce overtime for officers who failed to perform well and re-assign those who fail to meet quotas to less desirable posts.

c. According to secretly tape recorded conversations made by Schoolcraft, a Lieutenant, a Deputy Inspector and Chief of transportation can be heard encouraging and demanding increased stops, summons and detentions and arrests.

d. Police Officer Craig Lance of the 42nd Precinct filed a lawsuit against the NYPD claiming the existence of a quota system and a systematic retaliation and harassment to those who did not comply.

e. Retired Detective James Griffin filed a lawsuit claiming that in the NYPD there exists a culture wherein officers who report corruption will face harassment and a hostile work environment and that this conduct was tolerated by supervisors within the NYPD.

f. Police Officer Minoia, an officer with an Ivy League degree, assigned to the 42nd Precinct, was reassigned to a “punishment post” due to the fact that he failed to write a sufficient amount of summons and stated “I’m not going to pull out my summons book and write a summons because my boss is telling me he’s going to make it difficult for me if I don’t.”

150. In sum, the CITY and NYPD are responsible for creating a custom, policy or practice wherein many officers do not seem to believe that anything is really wrong with stopping and searching innocent citizens or using unnecessary or excessive force or falsely arresting citizens to meet an arrest quota.

151. That the above customs, policies and/or practices and the deliberate indifference thereto, was a direct and proximate cause of the illegal seizure of Plaintiff **CURTIS SMALLWOOD**, the

excessive use of force on Plaintiff, and the false arrest and malicious prosecution of Plaintiff. The CITY and NYPD'S polices, customs and/or practices deprived the Plaintiff of his rights and liberties as set forth in the Constitutions of the United States and the State of New York and under 42 U.S.C §§ 1983, 1986 and 1988.

152. That said actions violated the Fourth and Fourteenth Amendments to the Constitution of the United States, violated Plaintiff's right to be secure in person, and that the defendants used excessive, unnecessary and unlawful force, which constituted cruel and inhumane treatment and denied him due process of law.

153. Moreover, the CITY and NYPD caused or created a policy and/or custom, and acted with deliberate indifference to patterns and/or police practices which included illegal seizures, excessive or arbitrary use of force, illegal use of police equipment, destruction of evidence, intimidation of witnesses, illegal arrests, failing to gather evidence when allegations of police misconduct are involved, condoning a code of silence within the NYPD regarding misconduct, failing to take police reports of illegal conduct, failing to properly supervise, train, investigate or discipline officers, and any and/or all of the above have contributed to Plaintiff's false arrest, malicious and false prosecution, and injuries.

154. That the Plaintiff did not commit any illegal act, either before or at the time he was falsely arrested and imprisoned, assaulted, battered and deprived of his constitutional rights as set forth in the Constitution of the United States and 42 U.S.C § 1983.

155. That by reason of the foregoing, Plaintiff **CURTIS SMALLWOOD** has been damaged in an amount that exceeds the jurisdictional limits of all lower trial courts of this state.

**AS AND FOR A FOURTEENTH CAUSE OF ACTION ON BEHALF OF
PLAINTIFF CURTIS SMALLWOOD**

156. Plaintiff **CURTIS SMALLWOOD** repeats, reiterates and realleges each and every

allegation contained in paragraphs numbered 1 - 155 with the same force and effect as if fully set forth at length herein.

157. At all times mentioned herein and above, defendants CITY and NYPD employed QUERY, DOE and ROE as police officers and named defendants were acting under color of law, to wit: the statutes, ordinances and regulations, policies and customs and usage of the State of New York and/or City of New York.

158. Plaintiff **CURTIS SMALLWOOD** is and at all times relevant herein, a citizen of the United States and a resident of Bronx County in the State of New York and brings this cause of action pursuant to 42 United States Code, Section 1983 and 42 United States Code, Section 1988.

159. That on or about 12/31/23, defendants CITY, NYPD, QUERY, DOE and ROE, without probable cause, reasonable cause or legal justification and while effectuating the seizure of plaintiff **CURTIS SMALLWOOD**, did search, seize, assault and commit a battery and grab the Plaintiff **CURTIS SMALLWOOD** without a court authorized arrest warrant or search warrant and defendants did physically seize Plaintiff **CURTIS SMALLWOOD** during the arrest process in an unlawful and excessive manner. Plaintiff **CURTIS SMALLWOOD** was falsely arrested, unlawfully imprisoned and searched and as a result of defendants' conduct maliciously prosecuted without the defendants possessing probable cause, reasonable cause or legal justification to do so.

160. The above actions of defendants CITY, NYPD, QUERY, DOE and ROE resulted in Plaintiff **CURTIS SMALLWOOD** being deprived of the following rights under the United States Constitution: a) Freedom from assault to his person; b) Freedom from battery to his person; c) Freedom from illegal search and seizure; d) Freedom from false arrest; e) Freedom from malicious prosecution; f) Freedom from the use of excessive force during the arrest process; and g) The right to Due Process of Law.

161. In addition to the above, defendants CITY and NYPD have as a matter of policy, custom and practice and with deliberate indifference failed to adequately train, monitor, supervise, discipline, sanction or otherwise direct its police officers, including the officers involved in this case and any and all unnamed officers involved in the unlawful seizure and arrest of plaintiff, regarding the protection of the constitutional rights of citizens.

162. Defendants CITY, NYPD, QUERY, DOE and ROE, subjected Plaintiff **CURTIS SMALLWOOD** to such deprivation in a malicious, reckless, deliberate, intentional, grossly negligent and with a callous disregard of Plaintiff **CURTIS SMALLWOOD'S** rights and with deliberate indifference to those rights under the Fourth, Fifth, Sixth, Fourteenth and all other related Amendments to the United States Constitution.

163. The direct and proximate result of the defendants CITY, NYPD, QUERY, DOE and ROE acts are that Plaintiff **CURTIS SMALLWOOD** has suffered severe and permanent injuries, loss of liberty and companionship, forced to endure pain and suffering, emotional distress and severe and significant damage to standing and reputation in the community.

164. That by reason of the foregoing, Plaintiff **CURTIS SMALLWOOD** has been damaged in an amount that exceeds the jurisdictional limits of all lower trial courts of this state.

AS AND FOR A FIFTEENTH CAUSE OF ACTION ON BEHALF OF
PLAINTIFF MIGUEL TAVERAS

165. Plaintiff **MIGUEL TAVERAS** repeats, reiterates and realleges each and every allegation contained in paragraphs numbered 1 – 164 with the same force and effect as if fully set forth at length herein.

166. That at all times the Plaintiff **MIGUEL TAVERAS** was and is a resident of County of the Bronx, City, and State of New York.

167. That on 12/31/23, at approximately, 8:00 p.m., Plaintiff **MIGUEL TAVERAS** was

lawfully in the vicinity of Willis Avenue and East 138th Street, County of Bronx, City and State of New York and doing nothing illegal, improper or acting suspicious in anyway.

168. That on 12/31/23, at approximately, 8:00 p.m., in the vicinity of Willis Avenue and East 138th Street, County of Bronx, City and State of New York, QUERY, DOE and ROE, absent an arrest warrant, probable cause, reasonable cause or any legal justification, and based on fraud, perjury and misrepresentations approached Plaintiff **MIGUEL TAVERAS** for no reason and summarily stopped, searched, grabbed, assaulted, battered, and detained him in an aggressive and excessive manner.

169. Upon information and belief QUERY, DOE and ROE knew or had reason to know that their actions lacked any legal justification in approaching, searching, seizing and arresting Plaintiff **MIGUEL TAVERAS** and that their actions were based on fraud, perjury and misrepresentations.

170. That Plaintiff **MIGUEL TAVERAS** was arraigned after his arrest and thereafter falsely and maliciously prosecuted with committing a crime.

171. Thereafter, Plaintiff **MIGUEL TAVERAS** remained incarcerated for over 24 hours and was required to make numerous court appearances over an extended period of time until all charges against him were terminated favorably.

172. Plaintiff **MIGUEL TAVERAS** sustained physical and emotional pain and injuries as a result of this incident.

173. That within ninety (90) days after the causes of actions accrued herein, and more than thirty (30) days prior to the commencement of this action, the Plaintiff **MIGUEL TAVERAS** caused the notice of claim, in writing, sworn to by and on behalf of the claimant, the Plaintiff herein, containing the statement of the name and place of residence of the claimant by the street and number

and his attorney, and describing the time when the particular claim and circumstances under which the damages and injuries were sustained, the cause thereof, and so far as practical, the nature and extent of the injuries to be personally served upon the defendant CITY, their agents, servants and/or employees at the Law Department.

174. This action was so commenced within one (1) year and ninety (90) days after said cause of action accrued herein, and for more than thirty (30) days prior to the commencement of this action, defendant CITY neglected, refused and failed to make an adjustment of said claim, and said claim remains unadjusted and unpaid, although plaintiff herein has requested and demanded that the same be paid and adjusted.

175. That the defendants requested an oral examination pursuant to General Municipal Law Section 50-H and said request was complied with.

**AS AND FOR A SIXTEENTH CAUSE OF ACTION ON BEHALF OF
PLAINTIFF MIGUEL TAVERAS**

176. Plaintiff **MIGUEL TAVERAS** repeats, reiterates and realleges each and every allegation contained in paragraphs numbered 1 – 175 with the same force and effect as if fully set forth at length herein.

177. That on or about 12/31/23, at approximately 8:00 p.m., the Plaintiff **MIGUEL TAVERAS** was without just cause, probable cause or provocation, and with reckless, negligent and callous disregard for the truth, and without investigation, touched, grabbed, handcuffed, seized and arrested in an excessive manner and with excessive force by CITY, NYPD, QUERY, DOE and ROE, their agents, servants and/or employees, and in particular, by QUERY, DOE and ROE.

178. That on or about 12/31/23, at approximately 8:00 p.m., the Plaintiff **MIGUEL TAVERAS** while lawfully in the vicinity of Willis Avenue and East 138th Street, County of Bronx, City and State of New York, was without just cause, probable cause or provocation, maliciously,

intentionally and falsely accused by CITY, NYPD, QUERY, DOE and ROE of having committed a crime.

179. That on or about 12/31/23, and upon arresting the Plaintiff **MIGUEL TAVERAS** and depriving him of his liberty, CITY, NYPD, QUERY, DOE and ROE took the Plaintiff **MIGUEL TAVERAS** to a police station in the County of Bronx and entered him on the records as under arrest.

180. That on or about 12/31/23, the CITY, NYPD, QUERY, DOE and ROE further caused Plaintiff **MIGUEL TAVERAS** to have his fingerprints and photographs to be taken without his consent and in accordance with police procedures for the arrest of criminals and held him on various criminal charges at various police stations, correctional facilities and at the courthouse located at 215 East 161st Street, County of Bronx, City and State of New York.

181. That on or about 12/31/23, Plaintiff **MIGUEL TAVERAS** was aware of his arrest and confinement, he did not consent to his arrest or confinement, and said confinement, seizure, arrest and detention was without legal justification.

182. That at all times hereinafter mentioned the actions of CITY, NYPD, QUERY, DOE and ROE as described above were carried out in a reckless, deliberate, willful, wanton, malicious and grossly negligent manner.

183. That by reason of the foregoing, Plaintiff **MIGUEL TAVERAS** has been damaged in an amount that exceeds the jurisdictional limits of all lower trial courts of this state.

AS AND FOR A SEVENTEENTH CAUSE OF ACTION ON BEHALF OF
PLAINTIFF MIGUEL TAVERAS

184. Plaintiff **MIGUEL TAVERAS** repeats, reiterates and realleges each and every allegation contained in paragraphs numbered 1 –183 with the same force and effect as if fully set forth at length herein.

185. That on or about 12/31/23, a criminal complaint was issued by the CITY, NYPD, QUERY, DOE and ROE, their agents, servants and/or employees, without probable cause, reasonable cause or legal justification.

186. That on or about 12/31/23 a criminal action against Plaintiff **MIGUEL TAVERAS** was commenced by CITY, NYPD, QUERY, DOE and ROE, their agents, servants and/or employees, without probable cause, reasonable cause or legal justification.

187. That solely as a result of the aforesaid, the Plaintiff **MIGUEL TAVERAS**' life was interfered with.

188. That the criminal action against Plaintiff **MIGUEL TAVERAS** was continued for an extended period of time by defendants with malice and bad faith.

189. That solely as a result of the false arrest, assault, battery, false imprisonment and malicious prosecution of the Plaintiff **MIGUEL TAVERAS**, he was deprived of his liberty for an extended period of time and was subjected to scorn, ridicule, embarrassment and was degraded in the esteem of the community both personally and professionally.

190. That the criminal action against Plaintiff **MIGUEL TAVERAS** was terminated by dismissal.

191. That the actions of CITY, NYPD, QUERY, DOE and ROE as described above were carried out in a reckless, deliberate, willful, wanton, malicious and grossly negligent manner.

192. That by reason of the foregoing, Plaintiff **MIGUEL TAVERAS** has been damaged in an amount that exceeds the jurisdictional limits of all lower trial courts of this state.

**AS AND FOR A EIGHTEENTH CAUSE OF ACTION ON BEHALF OF
PLAINTIFF MIGUEL TAVERAS**

193. Plaintiff **MIGUEL TAVERAS** repeats, reiterates and realleges each and every allegation contained in paragraphs numbered 1 - 192 with the same force and effect as if fully set

forth at length herein.

194. That on or about 12/31/23, and while in the custody of the defendants in the County of Bronx, City of New York, the Plaintiff **MIGUEL TAVERAS** was intentionally touched, pushed, assaulted, battered, violated, searched, humiliated, photographed and handcuffed in the most egregious and excessive manner by the CITY, NYPD, QUERY, DOE and ROE, who were acting within the scope of their employment and authority in such a manner as to knowingly cause injury to plaintiff.

195. That on or about 12/31/23 CITY, NYPD, QUERY, DOE and ROE, their agents, servants and employees, acting as agents and on behalf of the CITY, NYPD, QUERY, DOE and ROE, within the scope of their employment, did intentionally, willfully and maliciously assault and batter the Plaintiff **MIGUEL TAVERAS** in the most egregious and excessive matter in that they have the real or apparent ability to cause imminent harmful and/or offensive bodily contact and intentionally did a violent and/or menacing act which threatened such contact to the Plaintiff **MIGUEL TAVERAS** and their act caused apprehension of such contact in the plaintiff, and in a hostile and/or offensive manner touched and beat the plaintiff and/or offensive bodily contact to the Plaintiff **MIGUEL TAVERAS** and caused such battery in and about his head, neck, back, body and limbs.

196. That by reason of the aforesaid intentional assault and battery which was committed in an excessive manner and with excessive force and without legal justification or privilege by the defendants, their agents, servants and employees, who were acting within the scope of their employment and authority and without any probable or reasonable cause, Plaintiff **MIGUEL TAVERAS** suffered great and permanent bodily injury in and about his head, neck, back, body and limbs and was rendered sick, sore, lame and disabled, and suffered conscious pain and suffering, and

that he was otherwise damaged.

197. That as a result of the aforesaid assault and battery the Plaintiff **MIGUEL TAVERAS** was caused to sustain serious, severe, painful and permanent bodily injuries so that she was rendered sick, sore, lame and disabled and so remains and was and will be compelled to seek medical aid and attention and incur expenses for same in an endeavor to cure himself of his said injuries and he was and will be prevented from attending his usual occupation and duties.

198. That at all times hereinafter mentioned the actions of CITY, NYPD, QUERY, DOE and ROE as described above were carried out in a reckless, deliberate, willful, wanton, malicious and grossly negligent manner.

199. That by reason of the foregoing, Plaintiff **MIGUEL TAVERAS** has been damaged in an amount that exceeds the jurisdictional limits of all lower trial courts of this state.

**AS AND FOR A NINETEENTH CAUSE OF ACTION ON BEHALF OF
PLAINTIFF MIGUEL TAVERAS**

200. Plaintiff **MIGUEL TAVERAS** repeats, reiterates and realleges each and every allegation contained in paragraphs numbered 1 –199 with the same force and effect as if fully set forth at length herein.

201. That the CITY, NYPD, their agents, servants and employees were negligent, careless and reckless in hiring, retaining, training, monitoring, retraining, supervising and promoting its employees including but not limited to QUERY, DOE and ROE, in that said police officers, as employees of CITY and NYPD, were not qualified to be hired or retained or promoted as police officers, lacked the experience, skill, training and ability to be employed, retained and utilized in the manner that each was employed by CITY and NYPD.

202. That the CITY and NYPD failed to exercise due care and caution in its hiring, retaining, training and/or promoting practices in that CITY and NYPD failed to adequately test,

analyze test results, and/or investigate above mentioned police officers backgrounds and performances.

203. That the CITY and NYPD failed to exercise due care and caution in its hiring, retaining, training and/or promoting practices in that CITY and NYPD failed to adequately screen said police officers, failed to adequately monitor said police officers, and failed to adequately discipline said police officers when they violate Patrol Guidelines.

204. Defendant CITY and NYPD were also negligent in that prior to and at the time of the acts complained of herein, due to the prior history of the police officer defendants named herein, knew or should have known of the bad disposition of said defendants, or at the very least had knowledge of facts that would put a reasonably prudent employer on inquiry concerning their bad disposition and the fact that defendant police officers were not suitable to be hired and employed by the CITY and NYPD and that due to their lack of training, these officers should have had adequate supervision so that they would not arrest innocent individuals nor use excessive force during the arrest process.

205. That by reason of the above, the Plaintiff **MIGUEL TAVERAS** was injured in mind and body as he was arrested, prosecuted and rendered sick, sore, and damaged.

206. That at all times hereinafter mentioned the actions of CITY, NYPD and all defendants herein as described above were carried out in a reckless, deliberate, willful, wanton, malicious and grossly negligent manner.

207. That by reason of the foregoing, Plaintiff **MIGUEL TAVERAS** has been damaged in an amount that exceeds the jurisdictional limits of all lower trial courts of this state.

**AS AND FOR A TWENTIETH CAUSE OF ACTION ON BEHALF OF
PLAINTIFF MIGUEL TAVERAS**

208. Plaintiff **MIGUEL TAVERAS** repeats, reiterates and realleges each and every

allegation contained in paragraphs numbered 1-207 with the same force and effect as if fully set forth at length herein.

209. In arresting Plaintiff **MIGUEL TAVERAS**, police officers including but not limited to QUERY, DOE and ROE, acting in their capacity as agents, servants and employees of CITY and NYPD, were motivated by an ulterior purpose to do harm, without justification or economic or social excuse.

210. In arresting Plaintiff **MIGUEL TAVERAS**, police officers including but not limited to QUERY, DOE and ROE, acting in their capacity as agents, servants and employees of CITY and NYPD, sought either a detriment to Plaintiff **MIGUEL TAVERAS** or a collateral advantage to the CITY and NYPD that is outside the legitimate ends of effectuating an arrest.

211. As a result of the abuse of process by defendants herein, Plaintiff **MIGUEL TAVERAS** sustained multiple injuries including but not limited to loss of liberty, emotional distress, humiliation, loss of enjoyment of life, and fear and intimidation for his safety.

212. That at all times hereinafter mentioned the actions of CITY, NYPD and all defendants herein as described above were carried out in a reckless, deliberate, willful, wanton, malicious and grossly negligent manner.

213. That by reason of the foregoing, Plaintiff **MIGUEL TAVERAS** has been damaged in an amount that exceeds the jurisdictional limits of all lower trial courts of this state.

**AS AND FOR A TWENTY-FIRST CAUSE OF ACTION ON BEHALF OF
PLAINTIFF MIGUEL TAVERAS**

214. Plaintiff **MIGUEL TAVERAS** repeats, reiterates and realleges each and every allegation contained in paragraphs numbered 1 - 213 with the same force and effect as if fully set forth at length herein.

215. That on 12/31/23, at approximately 8:00 p.m., within the vicinity of Willis Avenue and

East 138th Street, County of Bronx, City and State of New York, the CITY and NYPD were present through its agents, servants and/or employees including but not limited to QUERY, DOE and ROE, who were acting in the course of their employment and under the color of law to wit: the statutes, ordinances and regulations, policies and customs and usage of the State of New York and/or City of New York.

216. That Plaintiff **MIGUEL TAVERAS** was lawfully in the above vicinity at the above time when he was stopped, questioned, searched and seized solely on the basis of his age and/or race and for no legal or legitimate reason.

217. That said illegal stop and seizure was part of the CITY'S custom and practice and/or practice of racial profiling, and/or meeting arrest or summons quotas, and/or the illegal stop and search of civilians which was authorized by, or met with the tacit approval of the CITY and NYPD under their "Stop, Question and Frisk" policy or program ("Stop and Frisk").

218. That under the "Stop and Frisk" program the CITY and NYPD permitted, condoned, or acted with deliberate indifference to the racial disparity of its' application, to the fact that unnecessary or illegal frisks or searches were conducted, that very low percentages of seizures, frisks and searches resulted in arrests or the recovery of contraband, that pretextual reasons are provided for "Stop and Frisk", that officers do not always fill out Stop and Frisk reports, i.e. UF-250s, and are not disciplined when they fail to do so, that stop and frisks are conducted without reasonable suspicion, and that the program of "Stop and Frisk" has resulted in illegal stops, seizures, frisks, arrests and the use of physical force.

219. That the CITY and NYPD have failed to discipline, train, monitor or retrain offending police officers who engaged in stops and frisks without any legal justification and has failed to discipline police officers who fail to fill out required UF-250s.

220. That the CITY and NYPD have failed to adequately investigate and/or discipline officers who use excessive force, stop and frisk innocent citizens who have not done anything illegal or acted in suspicious manner warranting a seizure, who failed to report misconduct of fellow officers, who destroy evidence, who engage in fraud, misrepresentations, deceit, and maliciously participate in and instigate prosecutions of innocent citizens.

221. It is alleged herein that Plaintiff **MIGUEL TAVERAS** was stopped and seized absent reasonable suspicion. That said actions of defendants were pursuant to an illegal and improper Stop and Frisk program that was promulgated by defendants. That such custom, policy and program has created a class of citizens, including Plaintiff **MIGUEL TAVERAS**, who have been illegally stopped and seized, searched and questioned based on their race, and in order to meet arrest quotas. Evidence of said policy is as follows:

a. That in a class action lawsuit David Floyd, et. al. v. City of New York, et. al., pending in United States District Court, Southern District of New York, 08 CIV 1034, in a decision dated 5/16/12 certifying a class action lawsuit, it was found that between the years of 2005 and 2009 a reported 2.8 million people in New York City have been stopped and frisked. Of said number more than 87% were minority citizens. Summons and arrests were issued or made in approximately 10% of the reported stops. Meaning that based on their own records, defendants' suspicions are incorrect approximately 9 out of 10 stops.

b. The Honorable Shira A. Scheindlin, found in the Floyd decision that:

- i. It is indisputable that NYPD has an enormous Stop and Frisk program;
- ii. Evidence shows that the Stop and Frisk program is organized and hierarchical;
- iii. Stop and Frisk program has been designed and revised at highest levels of defendants;

- iv. The implementation of the program is conducted according to uniform and centralized rules;
- v. Monitoring of the program is hierarchical;
- vi. The program is the result of institutional decisions and directives.

c. Justice Sheindlin further found that a preponderance of evidence shows that defendants policy of establishing performance standards and demanding increased levels of stop and frisks results in putative class of aggrieved citizens. The Court noted that street level stops have risen every year. That in 2004, defendants documented 313,000 stops, and in 2011 they reported 684,000 stops. In a Police Officer Performance Objectives Operation Order dated 10/17/11, Commissioner Kelly directed that “Department managers can and must set performance goals – relating to “the issuance of summons, the stopping and questioning of suspicious individuals and the arrests of criminals.” It further states that “uniformed members who do not demonstrate activities . . . or who fail to engage in proactive activities . . . will be evaluated accordingly and their assignments reassessed.”

222. Other instances of an illegal and/or improper stop and frisk program custom or practice and/or excessive use of force and filing of false charges includes but not limited to:

a. On 4/12/11 in the vicinity of Walton Avenue and Mt. Hope Place, Bronx, NY, while doing nothing illegal or improper, Lonnie Thompson was approached by several uniformed police officers for no reason and without reasonable suspicion. After being stopped, Mr. Thompson was patted down and searched. He was arrested and charged with Criminal Possession of a Weapon in the Fourth Degree. This, even though the weapon was a bona fide work tool. Mr. Thompson was subjected to a strip search at the 46th Precinct. All charges were dismissed.

b. On 5/4/11 in the vicinity of 2345 Jerome Avenue, Bronx, NY, Alexis Niewkerk, who is

handicapped, was sitting in his legally parked vehicle and waiting for his friends to finish shopping at a nearby store. All of a sudden several undercover police officers from Bronx Narcotics approached his vehicle for no reason and without reasonable suspicion ordered him out of said vehicle. Mr. Niewkerk was subjected to a pat down and search. He was subsequently arrested for possession of a controlled substance in the seventh degree even though the “substance” recovered from his pants pocket was his own prescribed pain medication. Mr. Niewkerk was subjected to a strip search and forced to move his body in ways that are extremely painful given his medical status and condition. All charges were dismissed.

c. On 6/2/11 in the vicinity of 985 Simpson Street, Bronx, NY, Jesus Rosario, an infant, was approached by several police officers from the 41st Precinct. He was told to “get on the wall” and thereafter patted down and searched. Mr. Rosario was accused of Trespassing in the Second Degree. Mr. Rosario was doing nothing illegal or improper at the time the officers approached as he was simply exiting 985 Simpson Street after visiting his father who resides in said building. After being arrested, Mr. Rosario was subjected to a strip search at the 41st Precinct. The case was declined to be prosecuted by the District Attorney’s Office.

d. On 8/1/12 in the vicinity of Willis Avenue and East 138th Street, Bronx, NY Nicholas Hernandez and Dilson Pena were sitting outside of their building on a public bench and doing nothing illegal or improper. All of a sudden, several police officers from the 41st Precinct approached them for no reason and told them to submit to a frisk. Mr. Hernandez and Mr. Pena were accused of possession of marihuana even though no marihuana was recovered. They were each subjected to a strip search at the 41st Precinct. All charges against them were declined to be prosecuted by the District Attorney’s Office.

e. On 1/22/11 in the vicinity of 808 Park Avenue, Brooklyn, NY, Captain Michelle Culp,

a now retired Captain for New York City Department of Corrections, was visiting her sick and elderly mother at the aforementioned address and decided to walk her mother's dog. In so doing, Captain Culp was approached by several uniform housing police officers and accused of Trespassing in the Second Degree. She was patted down and searched. This, despite the fact that Captain Culp explained that she was visiting her mother and her identification and personal belongings were in her mother's apartment in the same building. All charges were dismissed.

f. On 5/20/11 in the vicinity of Park Avenue and East 138th Street, Bronx, NY, Patrick Nielson was exiting the number 4 subway train and going to his car which was parked nearby when he was followed, stopped, frisked, and assaulted by several undercover police officers from Bronx Narcotics for no reason. Thereafter, he was arrested and accused of possession of a controlled substance. Mr. Nielson was subjected to a strip search. The "controlled" substance was Mr. Nielson's prescribed medicine. All charges were dismissed.

g. On 6/22/10 in the vicinity of 139th Street and Lenox Avenue, New York, NY, Wilford Person was approached by several undercover police officers from Manhattan North Narcotics for no legitimate reason. Mr. Person was thereafter told to get against a fence and patted down and searched. He was accused of possession of marihuana. Mr. Person was simply playing basketball at the time the police approached him. After being arrested and subjected to a strip search Mr. Person was prosecuted. All charges were eventually dismissed.

h. On 5/2/12 in the vicinity of 1912 Third Avenue, New York, NY, Jose Baez, the manager of a local eyeglass store, left the store to buy his lunch. After leaving the store Mr. Baez, for no reason at all, was approached by several undercover police officers from Manhattan North Narcotics, and was detained, patted down, searched, and falsely accused of selling marihuana. Mr. Baez was subjected to a strip search. All charges against him were dismissed.

i. On 11/13/10 in the vicinity of 1113 Boston Road, Bronx, NY, Alpha Mahoi, was doing nothing illegal or improper when, for no reason, he was approached by several undercover police officers from Bronx Narcotics and accused of being involved in the sale of cocaine. He was cuffed, patted down, searched, arrested and strip searched at the precinct. All charges were dismissed.

j. On 3/10/12 in the vicinity of 1821 Davison Avenue, Bronx, NY, Keyewanie Blackledge, Dwayne Smith and Richard Campbell were leaving his friend's apartment when they were approached by several uniform police officers from the 46th Precinct for no reason and told to "get on the wall" and "get on the floor" and thereafter patted down and searched. They was charged with Trespassing in the Second Degree. All charges were dismissed.

k. On 8/1/12 in the vicinity of Willis Avenue and East 138th Street, Bronx, NY, Dylan Pena was outside recording on his cell phone several police officers from the 41st Precinct arresting a person from the neighborhood. Upon seeing Mr. Pena recording the incident several police officers grabbed him and pushed him to the ground and seized his cell phone without any reason to do so. All data on the phone was subsequently erased by the officers. Mr. Pena was also patted down and searched. He was charged with resisting arrest and was strip searched at the 41st Precinct. The charges were declined to be prosecuted by the District Attorney's Office.

l. On 5/17/11 in the vicinity of 1690 Clay Avenue, Bronx, NY, Gregory Williams was leaving a family friend's apartment after helping her move furniture so she could clean. Upon exiting the building Mr. Williams, for no reason at all, was approached by several uniformed police officers from the 44th Precinct and patted down and searched. He was accused of Trespassing in the Second Degree despite his family friend informing the police officers at the scene and at the 44th Precinct that he had permission to be in the building. Mr. Williams was strip searched. All charges against him were dismissed.

m. On 3/16/11 in the vicinity of 1740 Grand Avenue, Bronx, NY, Lindon Grant just left his apartment to walk approximately 1 block to buy breakfast before going to work. After he bought his breakfast and left the store he was approached by several undercover police officers from the 46th Precinct for no reason and patted down and searched. He was then accused of selling marihuana. Mr. Grant was arrested, strip searched and prosecuted for several months. All charges were dismissed.

n. On 8/2/09 in the vicinity of Southern Boulevard and East 175th Street, Bronx, NY Jose Suazo was approached by several uniformed officers from the 42nd Precinct for no reason. Mr. Suazo was patted down and searched. Despite the fact that he had nothing illegal on his person he was charged with possession of marihuana. While already in custody in a police van shots were fired in a nearby park. When Mr. Suazo got to the precinct he found out that even though he was already in custody in the police van when the shots were fired, he was charged with possession of a weapon in the second degree. Mr. Suazo was subjected to a strip search. All charges were eventually dismissed.

o. On 8/12/19 in the vicinity of Marion Avenue and Dorothea Place, Bronx, NY, Edmanuel Benitez was standing outside of the building and waiting for a friend to come outside to play basketball. All of a sudden he was approached for no reason by officers from the 41st Precinct and thereafter patted down, searched, arrested, strip searched and prosecuted for the sale of marihuana. All charges were dismissed.

p. On 2/19/12 Daniel Rodriguez was leaving a store in the vicinity of Jerome Avenue and West 192nd Street when he was summarily grabbed, pushed against a wall, patted down, frisked, searched and then handcuffed by several officers from Bronx Narcotics. Mr. Rodriguez was doing nothing illegal or improper at the time. He was subsequently strip searched and charged with

possession of a controlled substance in the seventh degree. All charges were dismissed.

q. On 9/28/11 Shakeem Enang was in the vicinity of West 179th Street and University Avenue when he was approached by several plain clothes officers from Bronx Narcotics Division. Mr. Enang was doing nothing illegal at the time the officers approached or any time prior to the officers approaching. He was grabbed, seized, frisked, searched and then arrested. Mr. Enang was charged with criminal sale of a controlled substance. He was strip searched at the 46th Precinct. All charges were dismissed.

223. As is evidence from the above, Plaintiff **MIGUEL TAVERAS**' injuries including the violation of his constitutional rights, the deprivation of his freedom, falsely and maliciously being prosecuted, physical and emotional injuries, are the direct and proximate result of the CITY'S and NYPD'S policies and/or deliberate indifference to practices which involve the excessive use of force, false arrest, police cover-ups, witness intimidation, malicious prosecution, illegal stop, questions and frisks, searches, Fourth Amendment violations, and deliberate indifference to the need to train, supervise, monitor, investigate and discipline, including suspension, dismissal and/or reassignment offending police officers. The practice is widespread and pervasive throughout the entire City of New York.

224. The CITY and NYPD knew or should have known of the customs and police practices of its officers which included but was not limited to: the failing to preserve and/or destruction of exculpatory evidence, threatening to arrest witnesses to police misconduct and engaging in cover-ups, fraud, perjury, deceit and malfeasance.

225. That the acts of employees of the CITY and NYPD, i.e. police officers, who violate the civil and constitutional rights of the citizens of the City of New York routinely go unreported, undisciplined and their acts condoned by other officers, including their supervisors. Upon

information and belief, the supervisors of defendant police officers herein were aware of the conduct of defendant police officers and failed to stop, report or intervene in the misconduct.

226. The CITY and NYPD'S tolerance for brutality, excessive force, illegal and/or retaliatory arrests, and their emphasis to come down hard on quality of life infractions leads to a systemic practice and policy wherein police officers seem fairly tolerant of police brutality, silence in the face of brutality and/or illegal stops, frisks, searches, seizures and/or arrests, and engage in the practice of meeting arrest quotas. A systemic practice where officers who report said misconduct are not viewed as "good cops" but rather as outcasts and are ostracized and often transferred to other assignments thereby perpetuating the illegal conduct of the NYPD and thusly the CITY.

227. Some instances where officers were treated as outcasts for reporting misconduct and/or arrest/summons quota system are as follows:

a. The existence of arrest quotas, summons quotas and approval of illegal stops and arrests have been exposed by Police officer Adrian Schoolcraft in a separate lawsuit which was cited by Justice Sheindlin in Floyd.

b. Justice Sheindlin referenced the deposition of Police Officer Adhily Polanco of the 41st Precinct stating that commanding officers set specific quotas for arrests and summons and for stop and frisks and threatened to reduce overtime for officers who failed to perform well and re-assign those who fail to meet quotas to less desirable posts.

c. According to secretly tape recorded conversations made by Schoolcraft, a Lieutenant, a Deputy Inspector and Chief of transportation can be heard encouraging and demanding increased stops, summons and detentions and arrests.

d. Police Officer Craig Lance of the 42nd Precinct filed a lawsuit against the NYPD claiming the existence of a quota system and a systematic retaliation and harassment to those who

did not comply.

e. Retired Detective James Griffin filed a lawsuit claiming that in the NYPD there exists a culture wherein officers who report corruption will face harassment and a hostile work environment and that this conduct was tolerated by supervisors within the NYPD.

f. Police Officer Minoia, an officer with an Ivy League degree, assigned to the 42nd Precinct, was reassigned to a “punishment post” due to the fact that he failed to write a sufficient amount of summons and stated “I’m not going to pull out my summons book and write a summons because my boss is telling me he’s going to make it difficult for me if I don’t.”

228. In sum, the CITY and NYPD are responsible for creating a custom, policy or practice wherein many officers do not seem to believe that anything is really wrong with stopping and searching innocent citizens or using unnecessary or excessive force or falsely arresting citizens to meet an arrest quota.

229. That the above customs, policies and/or practices and the deliberate indifference thereto, was a direct and proximate cause of the illegal seizure of Plaintiff **MIGUEL TAVERAS**, the excessive use of force on Plaintiff, and the false arrest and malicious prosecution of Plaintiff. The CITY and NYPD’S policies, customs and/or practices deprived the Plaintiff of his rights and liberties as set forth in the Constitutions of the United States and the State of New York and under 42 U.S.C §§ 1983, 1986 and 1988.

230. That said actions violated the Fourth and Fourteenth Amendments to the Constitution of the United States, violated Plaintiff’s right to be secure in person, and that the defendants used excessive, unnecessary and unlawful force, which constituted cruel and inhumane treatment and denied her due process of law.

231. Moreover, the CITY and NYPD caused or created a policy and/or custom, and acted

with deliberate indifference to patterns and/or police practices which included illegal seizures, excessive or arbitrary use of force, illegal use of police equipment, destruction of evidence, intimidation of witnesses, illegal arrests, failing to gather evidence when allegations of police misconduct are involved, condoning a code of silence within the NYPD regarding misconduct, failing to take police reports of illegal conduct, failing to properly supervise, train, investigate or discipline officers, and any and/or all of the above have contributed to Plaintiff's false arrest, malicious and false prosecution, and injuries.

232. That the Plaintiff did not commit any illegal act, either before or at the time he was falsely arrested and imprisoned, assaulted, battered and deprived of his constitutional rights as set forth in the Constitution of the United States and 42 U.S.C § 1983.

233. That by reason of the foregoing, Plaintiff **MIGUEL TAVERAS** has been damaged in an amount that exceeds the jurisdictional limits of all lower trial courts of this state.

**AS AND FOR A TWENTY-SECOND CAUSE OF ACTION ON BEHALF OF
PLAINTIFF MIGUEL TAVERAS**

234. Plaintiff **MIGUEL TAVERAS** repeats, reiterates and realleges each and every allegation contained in paragraphs numbered 1 - 233 with the same force and effect as if fully set forth at length herein.

235. At all times mentioned herein and above, defendants CITY and NYPD employed QUERY, DOE and ROE as police officers and named defendants were acting under color of law, to wit: the statutes, ordinances and regulations, policies and customs and usage of the State of New York and/or City of New York.

236. Plaintiff **MIGUEL TAVERAS** is and at all times relevant herein, a citizen of the United States and a resident of Bronx County in the State of New York and brings this cause of action pursuant to 42 United States Code, Section 1983 and 42 United States Code, Section 1988.

237. That on or about 12/31/23, defendants CITY, NYPD, QUERY, DOE and ROE, without probable cause, reasonable cause or legal justification and while effectuating the seizure of plaintiff **MIGUEL TAVERAS**, did search, seize, assault and commit a battery and grab the Plaintiff **MIGUEL TAVERAS** without a court authorized arrest warrant or search warrant and defendants did physically seize Plaintiff **MIGUEL TAVERAS** during the arrest process in an unlawful and excessive manner. Defendants interfered with Plaintiff **MIGUEL TAVERAS**' federal and state constitutional right to record law enforcement activity. Plaintiff **MIGUEL TAVERAS** was falsely arrested, unlawfully imprisoned and searched and as a result of defendants' conduct maliciously prosecuted without the defendants possessing probable cause, reasonable cause or legal justification to do so.

238. The above actions of defendants CITY, NYPD, QUERY, DOE and ROE resulted in Plaintiff **MIGUEL TAVERAS** being deprived of the following rights under the United States Constitution: a) Freedom from assault to his person; b) Freedom from battery to his person; c) Freedom from illegal search and seizure; d) Freedom from false arrest; e) Freedom from malicious prosecution; f) Freedom from the use of excessive force during the arrest process; and g) the right to Due Process of Law; h) Freedom of speech which includes the right to record law enforcement activities under the First Amendment of the U.S. Constitution, Article I Section 8 of the New York State Constitution, New York Civil Rights Law Section 79-p and NYC Administrative Code Section 14-189.

239. In addition to the above, defendants CITY and NYPD have as a matter of policy, custom and practice and with deliberate indifference failed to adequately train, monitor, supervise, discipline, sanction or otherwise direct its police officers, including the officers involved in this case and any and all unnamed officers involved in the unlawful seizure and arrest of plaintiff, regarding

the protection of the constitutional rights of citizens.

240. Defendants CITY, NYPD, QUERY, DOE and ROE, subjected Plaintiff **MIGUEL TAVERAS** to such deprivation in a malicious, reckless, deliberate, intentional, grossly negligent and with a callous disregard of Plaintiff **MIGUEL TAVERAS**' rights and with deliberate indifference to those rights under the First, Fourth, Fifth, Sixth, Fourteenth and all other related Amendments to the United States Constitution.

241. The direct and proximate result of the defendants CITY, NYPD, QUERY, DOE and ROE acts are that Plaintiff **MIGUEL TAVERAS** has suffered severe and permanent injuries, loss of liberty and companionship, forced to endure pain and suffering, emotional distress and severe and significant damage to standing and reputation in the community.

242. That at all times hereinafter mentioned the actions of CITY, NYPD and all defendants herein as described above were carried out in a reckless, deliberate, willful, wanton, malicious and grossly negligent manner.

243. That by reason of the foregoing, Plaintiff **MIGUEL TAVERAS** has been damaged in an amount that exceeds the jurisdictional limits of all lower trial courts of this state.

**AS AND FOR A TWENTY-THIRD CAUSE OF ACTION ON BEHALF OF
PLAINTIFF MIGUEL TAVERAS**

244. Plaintiff **MIGUEL TAVERAS** repeats, reiterates and realleges each and every allegation contained in paragraphs numbered 1 - 243 with the same force and effect as if fully set forth at length herein.

245. Plaintiff **MIGUEL TAVERAS'S** right to record law enforcement activity in a public place is protected by the First Amendment to the U.S. Constitution as well as Article I Section 8 of the New York State Constitution.

246. Plaintiff **MIGUEL TAVERAS** was exercising the aforementioned right on or about

12/31/23 within the vicinity of Willis Avenue and East 138th Street, Bronx, NY.

247. Defendants, including but not limited to CITY, NYPD, QUERY, DOE and ROE arrested Plaintiff **MIGUEL TAVERAS** on or about 12/31/23 in retaliation for Plaintiff exercising his protected activities under the First Amendment to the U.S. Constitution as well as Article I Section 8 of the New York State Constitution.

248. Plaintiff **MIGUEL TAVERAS**' arrest was motivated or substantially caused by his exercise of his right to record law enforcement activities.

249. That at all times hereinafter mentioned the actions of CITY, NYPD and all defendants herein as described above were carried out in a reckless, deliberate, willful, wanton, malicious and grossly negligent manner.

250. That by reason of the foregoing, Plaintiff **MIGUEL TAVERAS** has been damaged in an amount that exceeds the jurisdictional limits of all lower trial courts of this state.

**AS AND FOR A TWENTY-FOURTH CAUSE OF ACTION ON BEHALF OF
PLAINTIFF MIGUEL TAVERAS**

251. Plaintiff **MIGUEL TAVERAS** repeats, reiterates and realleges each and every allegation contained in paragraphs numbered 1 - 250 with the same force and effect as if fully set forth at length herein.

252. The New York City Right to Record Act provides a private cause of action to those whose right to record police activity is unlawfully interfered with. *See* N.Y.C. Admin. Code Section 14-189.

253. On 12/31/23, Plaintiff **MIGUEL TAVERAS** attempted to record law enforcement activities within the vicinity of Willis Avenue and East 138th Street, Bronx, NY, in accordance with N.Y.C. Admin. Code Section 14-189(b).

254. Defendants, including but not limited to CITY, NYPD, QUERY, DOE and ROE, interfered with Plaintiff **MIGUEL TAVERAS'S** right to record law enforcement activity by arresting him without legal justification and without probable cause and in retaliation for his recording activities.

254. The arrest of Plaintiff **MIGUEL TAVERAS** was a pretext to physically stop him from recording law enforcement activity, specifically the activities of named defendants.

255. That at all times hereinafter mentioned the actions of CITY, NYPD and all defendants herein as described above were carried out in a reckless, deliberate, willful, wanton, malicious and grossly negligent manner.

256. That by reason of the foregoing, Plaintiff **MIGUEL TAVERAS** has been damaged in an amount that exceeds the jurisdictional limits of all lower trial courts of this state.

**AS AND FOR A TWENTY-FIFTH CAUSE OF ACTION ON BEHALF OF
PLAINTIFF MIGUEL TAVERAS**

257. Plaintiff **MIGUEL TAVERAS** repeats, reiterates and realleges each and every allegation contained in paragraphs numbered 1-256 with the same force and effect as if fully set forth at length herein.

258. Plaintiff **MIGUEL TAVERAS** brings this cause of action pursuant to New York Civil Rights Law Section 79-p(3) for interfering with his right to record law enforcement activity.

259. On or about 12/31/23, within the vicinity of Willis Avenue and East 138th Street, Bronx, NY, Plaintiff **MIGUEL TAVERAS** exercised his right to record law enforcement activity as set forth in New York Civil Rights Law Section 79-p(2).

260. Defendants, including but not limited to CITY, NYPD, QUERY, DOE and ROE, interfered with Plaintiff **MIGUEL TAVERAS'** right to record law enforcement activity by arresting

him without legal justification and without probable cause and in retaliation for his recording activities.

261. That at all times hereinafter mentioned the actions of CITY, NYPD and all defendants herein as described above were carried out in a reckless, deliberate, willful, wanton, malicious and grossly negligent manner.

262. That by reason of the foregoing, Plaintiff **MIGUEL TAVERAS** has been damaged in an amount that exceeds the jurisdictional limits of all lower trial courts of this state.

**AS AND FOR A TWENTY-SIXTH CAUSE OF ACTION ON BEHALF OF
PLAINTIFF MIGUEL TAVERAS**

263. Plaintiff **MIGUEL TAVERAS** repeats, reiterates and realleges each and every allegation contained in paragraphs numbered 1 - 262 with the same force and effect as if fully set forth at length herein.

264. All Defendants herein, including defendants CITY, NYPD, QUERY, DOE and ROE, acting in concert and aiding and abetting the others, created false police reports and summons reports falsely claiming that they observed Plaintiff acting in a disorderly way, making unreasonable noise, obstructing vehicular traffic, fighting or acting in a violent, tumultuous or threatening way in the vicinity of Willis Avenue and East 138th Street, Bronx, NY.

265. The aforesaid misleading, false, and untrue information contained in those false reports and the information omitted from them was likely to influence a prosecutor to lodge charges against Plaintiff as well as a jury's decision.

266. The named and unnamed Defendants then forwarded aforesaid reports to prosecutors who in turn relied on them to commence formal criminal proceedings against Plaintiff.

267. Defendants' actions deprived Plaintiff of his right to not be prosecuted on fabricated

evidence, and to a fair trial under the Fifth, Sixth and Fourteenth Amendments to the U.S. Constitution, and were the proximate cause of Plaintiff's injuries and as such entitle Plaintiff to recover damages pursuant to 42. U.S.C. Section 1983.

268. That at all times hereinafter mentioned the actions of CITY, NYPD and all defendants herein as described above were carried out in a reckless, deliberate, willful, wanton, malicious and grossly negligent manner.

269. That by reason of the foregoing, Plaintiff **MIGUEL TAVERAS** has been damaged in an amount that exceeds the jurisdictional limits of all lower trial courts of this state

WHEREFORE, the Plaintiff **DEREK THOMAS** demands judgment against the defendants on the First Cause of Action through the Seventh Cause of Action in a sum that exceeds the jurisdictional limits of all lower trial courts of this state for each cause of action, the Plaintiff **CURTIS SMALLWOOD** demands judgment against the defendants on the Eighth Cause of Action through the Fourteenth Cause of Action in a sum that exceeds the jurisdictional limits of all lower trial courts of this state for each cause of action, the Plaintiff **MIGUEL TAVERAS** demands judgment against the defendants on the Fifteenth Cause of Action through the Twenty-Sixth Cause of Action in a sum that exceeds the jurisdictional limits of all lower trial courts of this state for each cause of action, all together with attorney's fees, punitive damages and the costs and disbursements of this action all together with attorney's fees, punitive damages and the costs and disbursements of this action.

Dated: Bronx, New York
June 11, 2024

Yours, etc.,

A handwritten signature in black ink, appearing to read 'Neil Wollerstein', written over a horizontal line.

NEIL WOLLERSTEIN, ESQ.

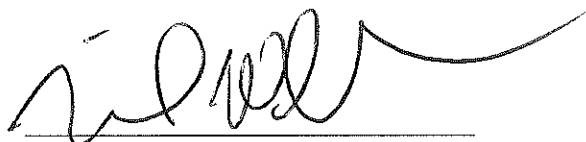
Attorney for Plaintiffs
895 Sheridan Avenue
Bronx, New York 10451
(718) 588-1300

ATTORNEY VERIFICATION

NEIL WOLLERSTEIN, an attorney duly admitted to practice before the courts of the State of New York affirms the following to be true pursuant to CPLR 2106 and under the penalties of perjury:

1. The undersigned, an attorney admitted to practice in the Courts of the State of New York states that he is retained on behalf of plaintiffs.
2. That affirmant has read the foregoing **SUPPLEMENTAL SUMMONS and AMENDED VERIFIED COMPLAINT** and knows the contents thereof; that the same is true to affirmant's own knowledge except as to the matters therein stated to be alleged on information and belief; and that as to those matters affirmant believes them to be true.
3. Your affirmant further says that the reason this verification is made by affirmant and not the plaintiffs is that the plaintiffs are not currently available.

Dated: Bronx, New York
June 11, 2024


NEIL WOLLERSTEIN

SUPREME COURT OF THE STATE OF NEW YORK
COUNTY OF BRONX

DEREK THOMAS, CURTIS SMALLWOOD and MIGUEL TAVERAS,

Plaintiffs,

– against –

**CITY OF NEW YORK, NEW YORK CITY POLICE DEPARTMENT, LIEUTENANT
BRIAN QUERY, POLICE OFFICER JOHN DOE and POLICE OFFICER JOHN ROE,**

Defendant(s).

SUPPLEMENTAL SUMMONS AND AMENDED VERIFIED COMPLAINT

NEIL WOLLERSTEIN, ESQ.

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